

EE/CE 252/251

Signals and Systems

with
Dr. Naveed R. Butt
@
Habib University

Signal Basics I

Types

Several classifications
of signals.

Examples

Some practice
problems

*Engineers like to
classify...*

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classify...*

Why?





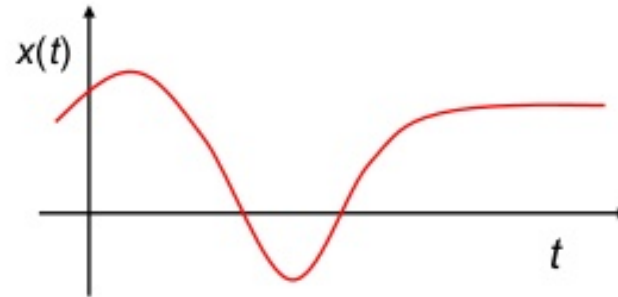
It helps
identify
different
classes of
problems and
develop tools
for them...



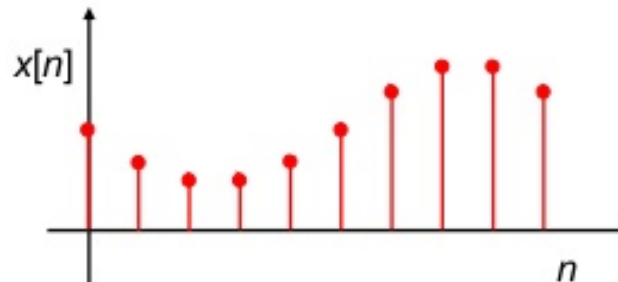
Let us ask a few questions about signals, each of which will lead to a classification...

1. Is the x-axis continuous or discrete?

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X-axis is a continuous variable (can take any value in a given range).



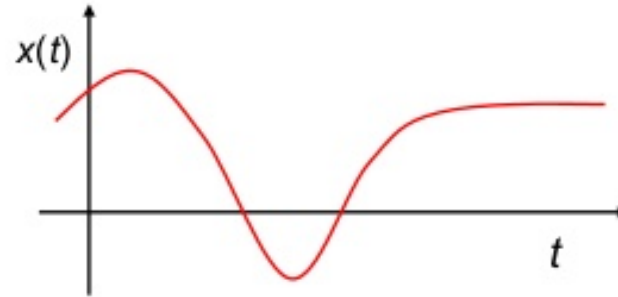
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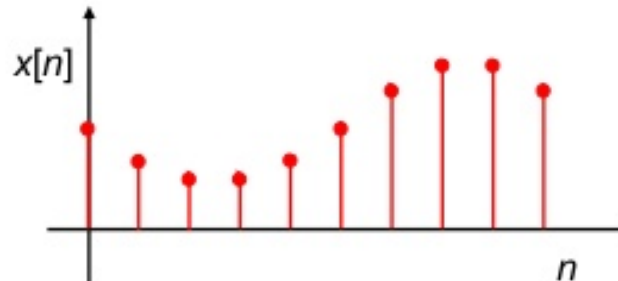
“Continuous-Time”

Vs.

“Discrete-Time”



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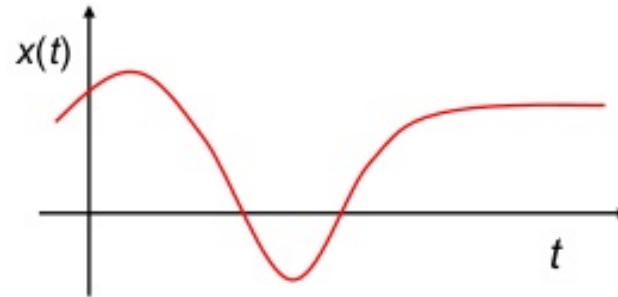
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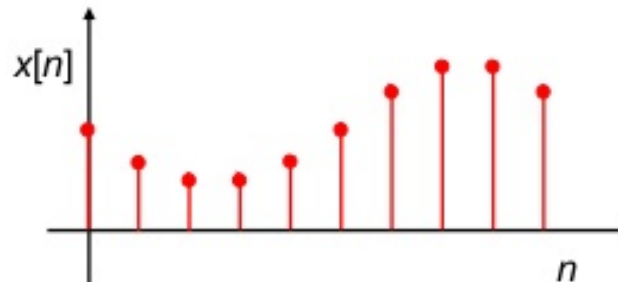
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Can you think of an example for each?



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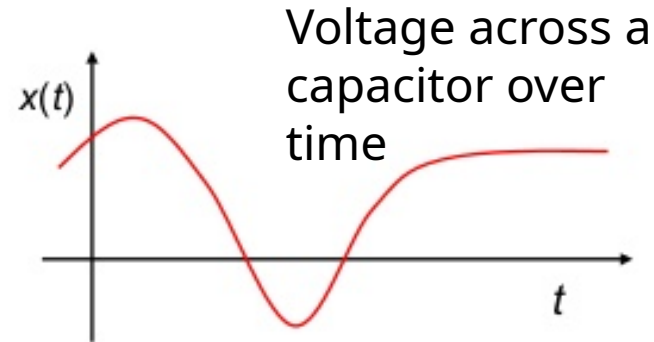
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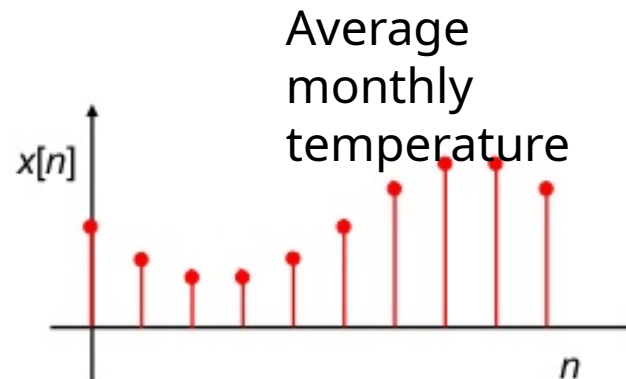
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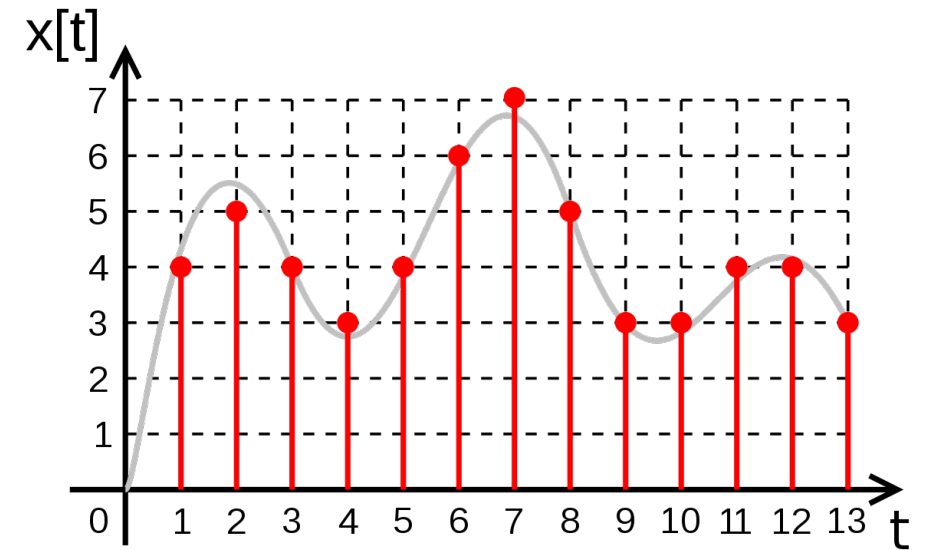
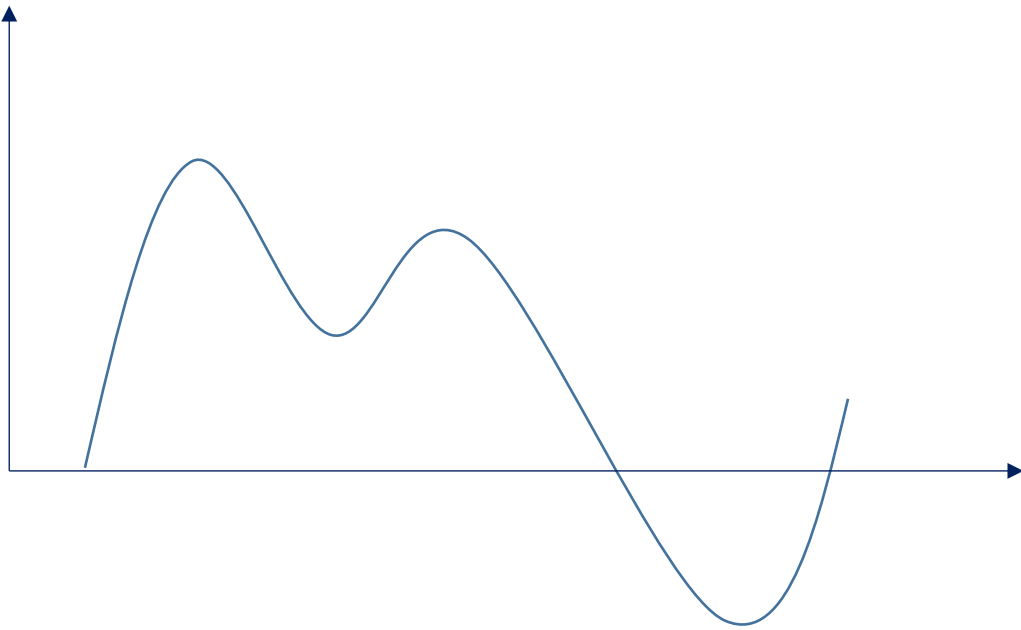
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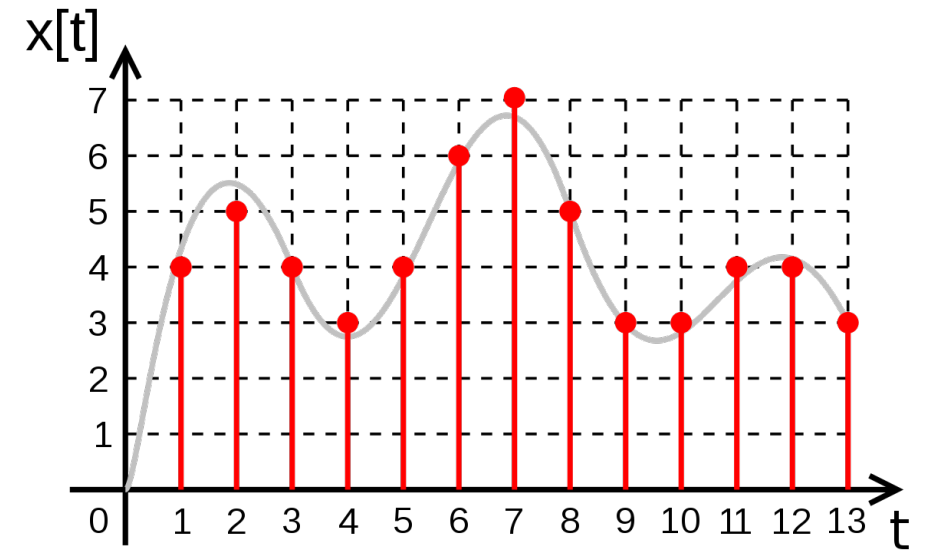
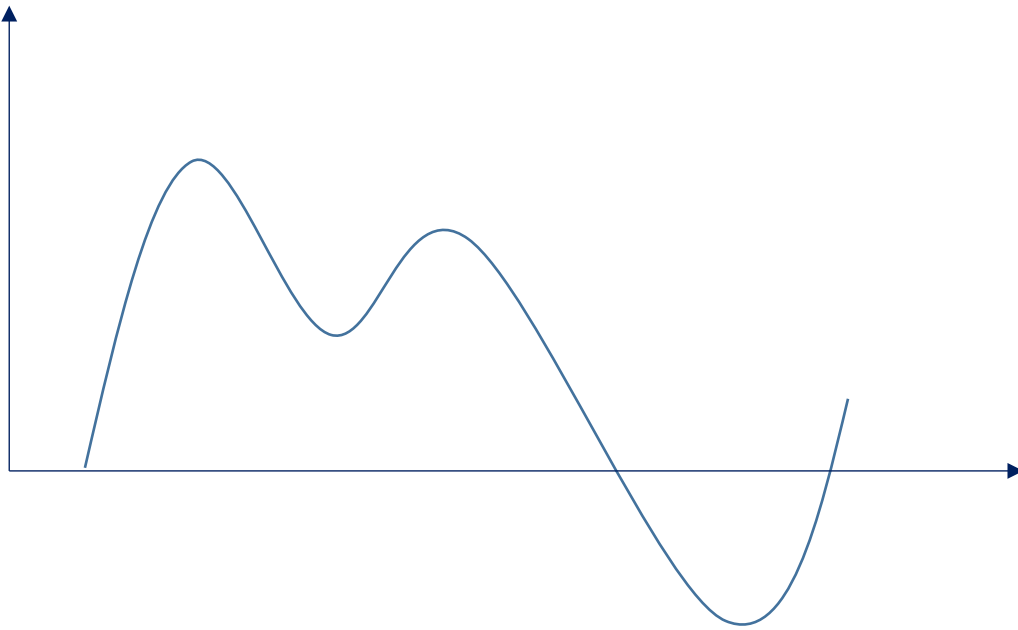


2. Is the y-axis also discrete (or continuous)?

“Analog”

Vs.

“Digital”



Analog

- Most signals in real life are analog.

Analog

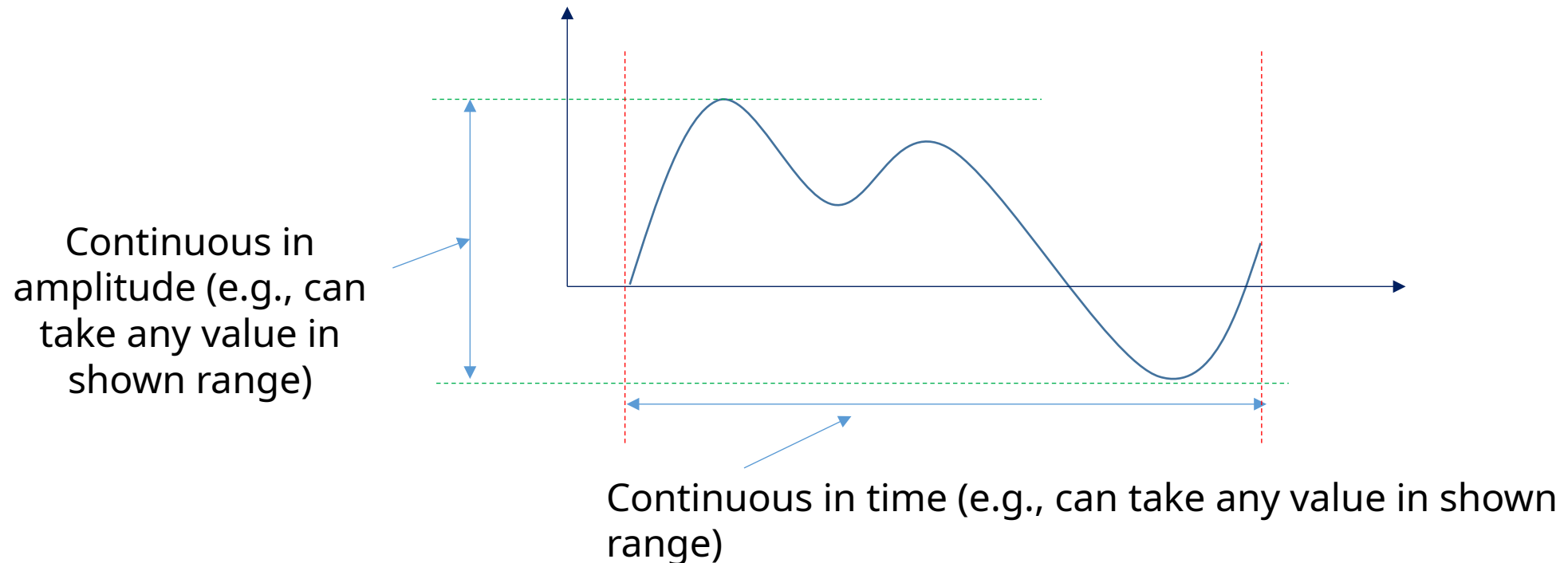
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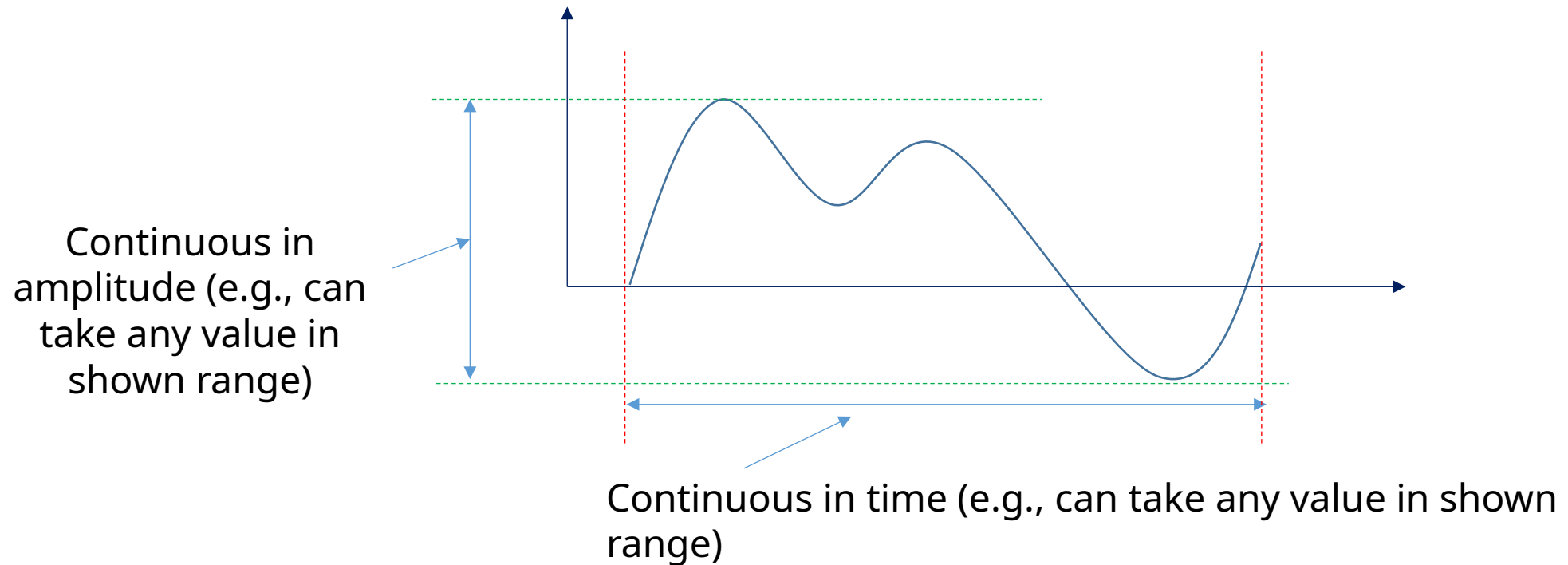
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 - e.g., temperature in this room



Digital

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Digital

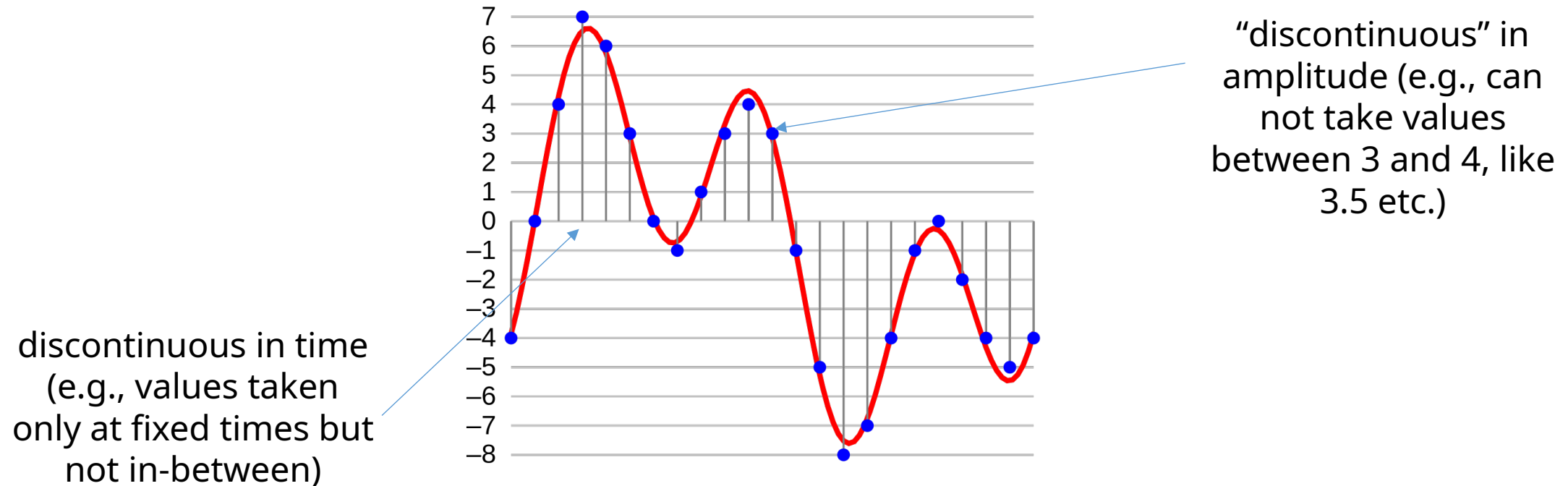
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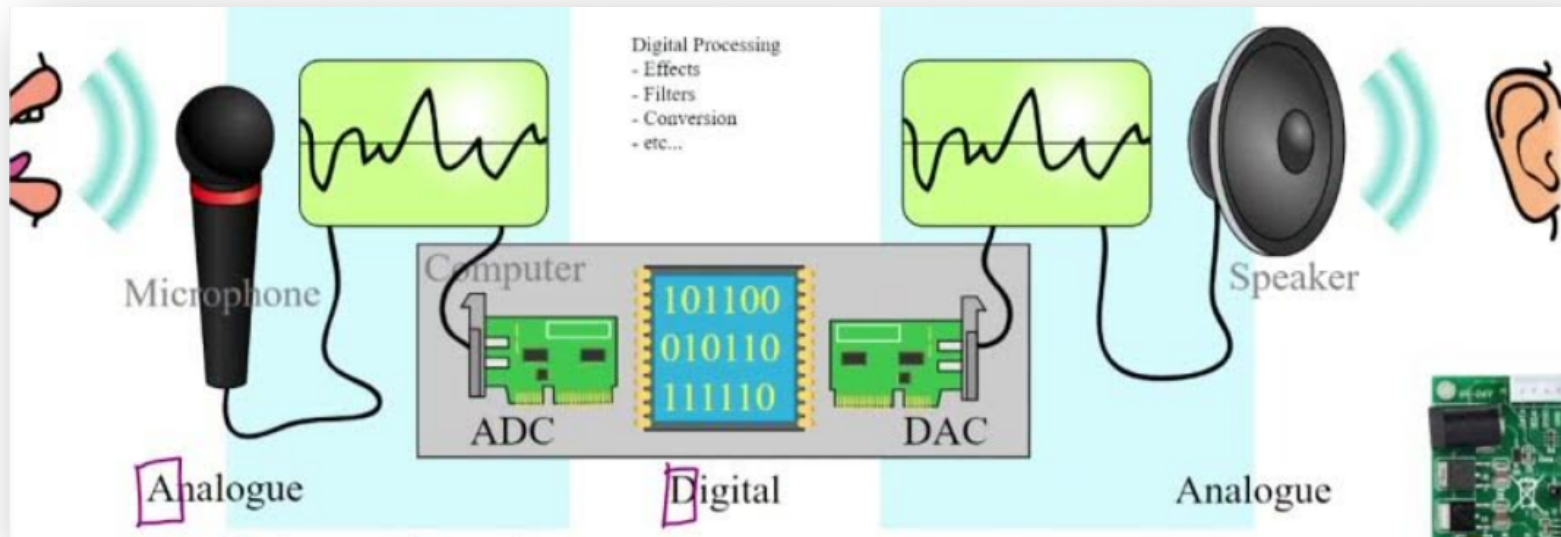
Digital Logic **in an** Analog World

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The modern approach to observing and handling the world around us is mostly *digital*.

Digital Logic in an Analog World

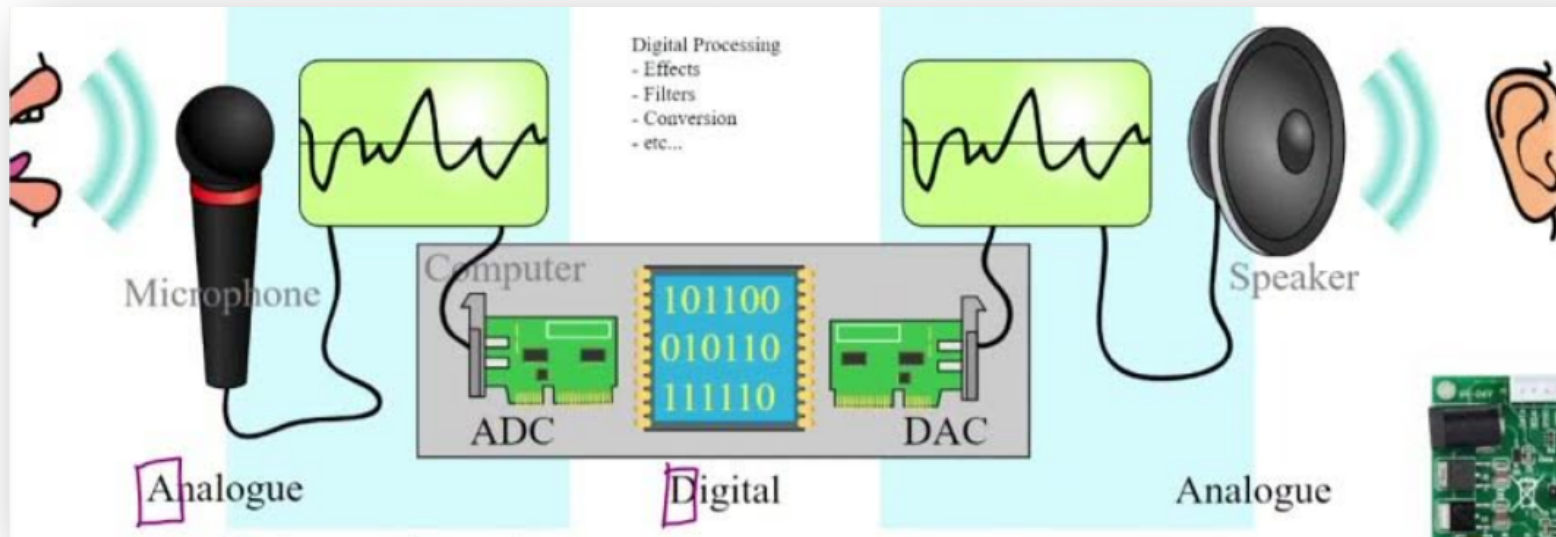
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<https://www.youtube.com/@ETphysics>

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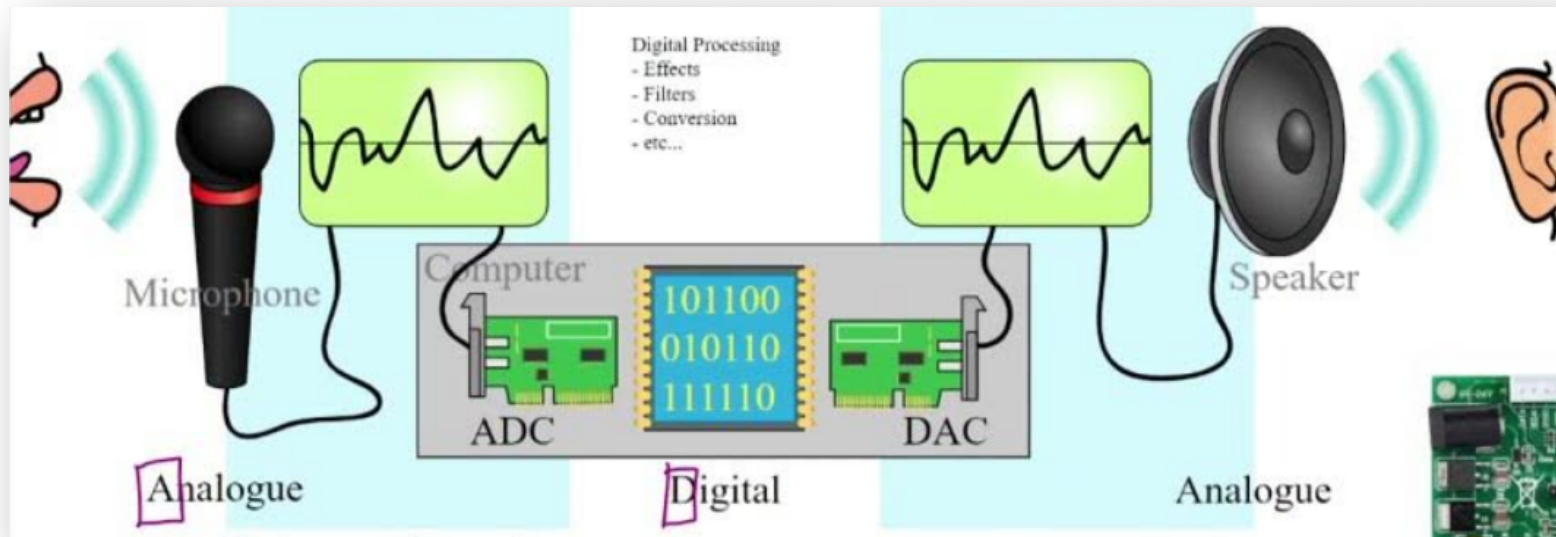


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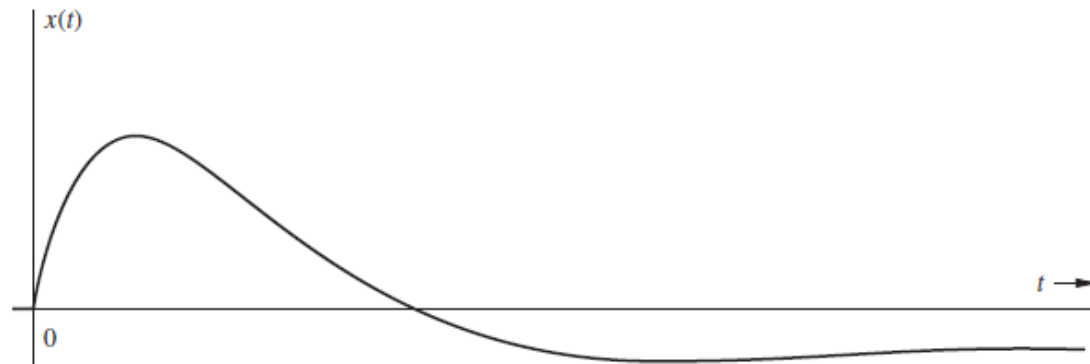
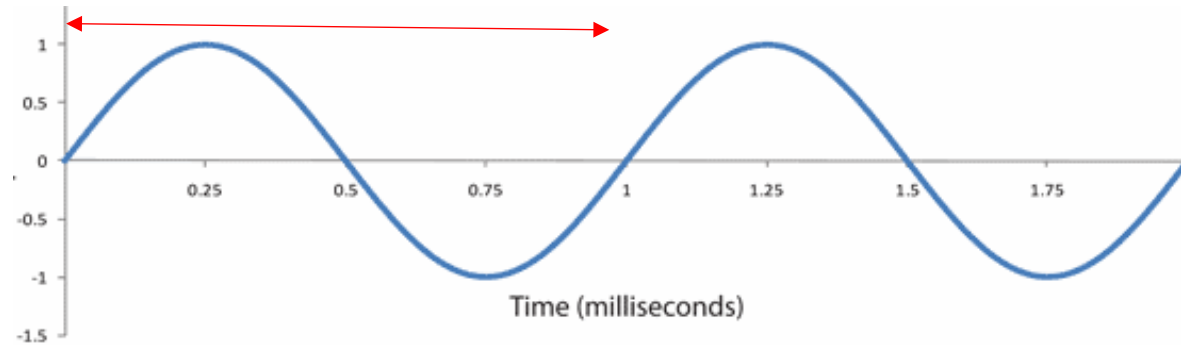


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- Data may be naturally discrete in time and value (e.g., often the case in financial models).
- But mostly: we digitize data by sampling/discretizing continuous signals/systems.

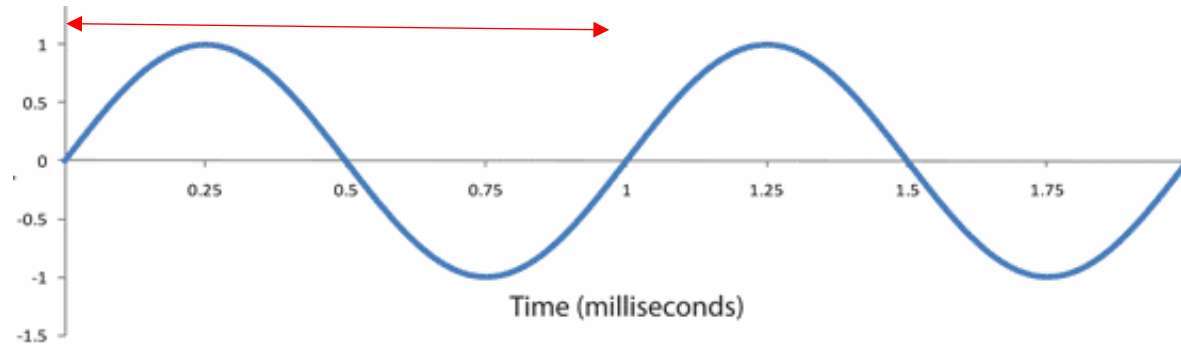
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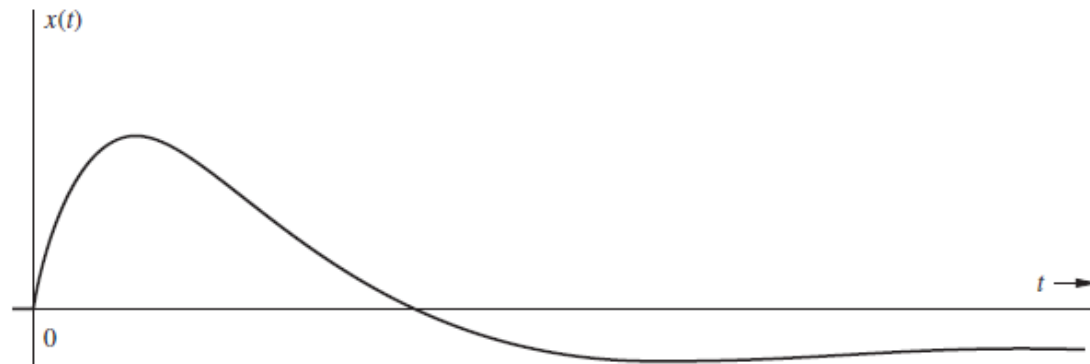
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“Periodic”



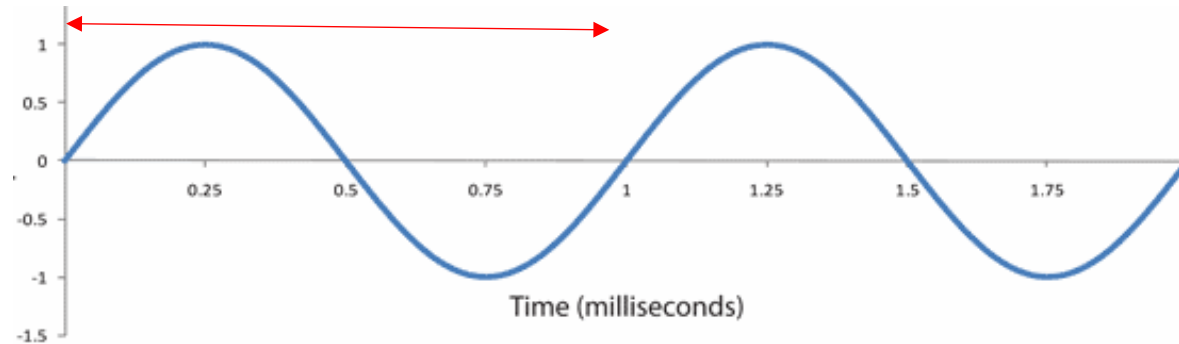
Vs.

“Aperiodic”



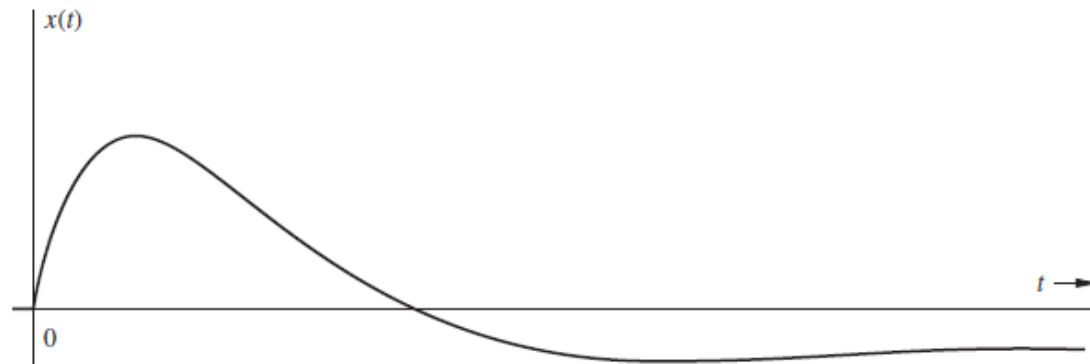
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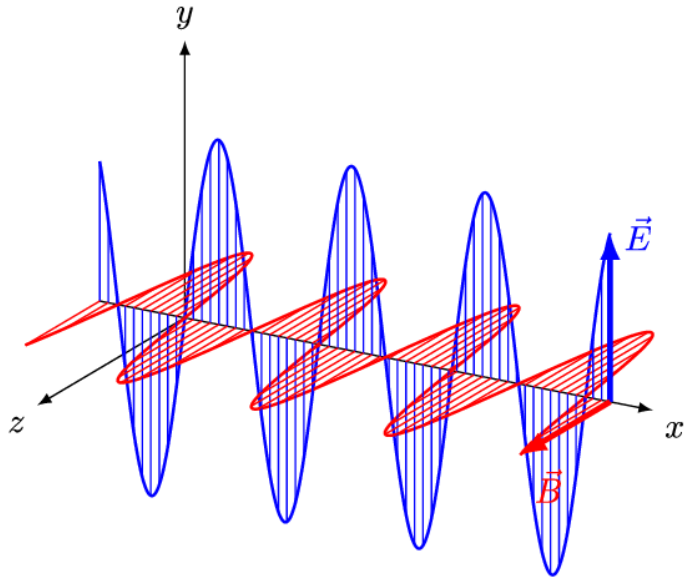
Vs.

“Aperiodic”



Can you think of a periodic and an aperiodic signal?

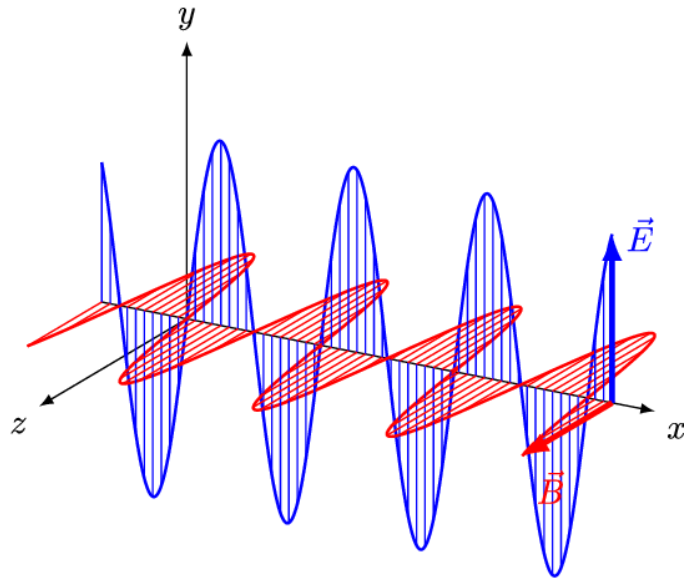
Periodic



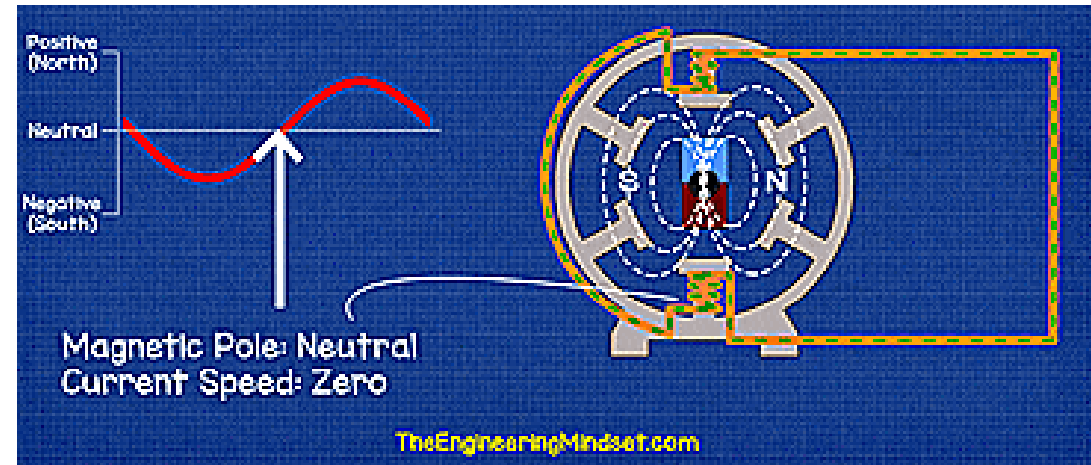
EM Waves

Periodic

c

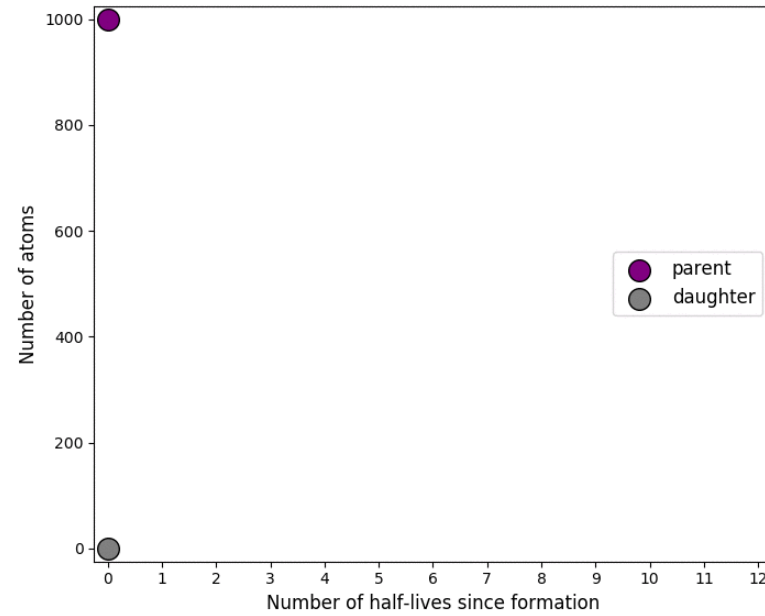
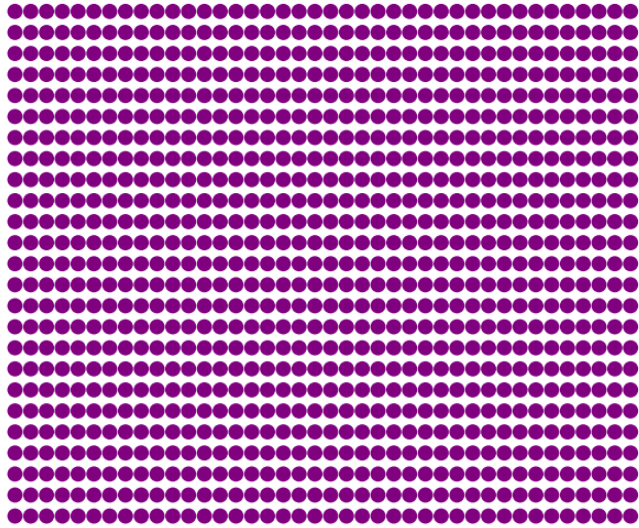


EM Waves



Alternating Current

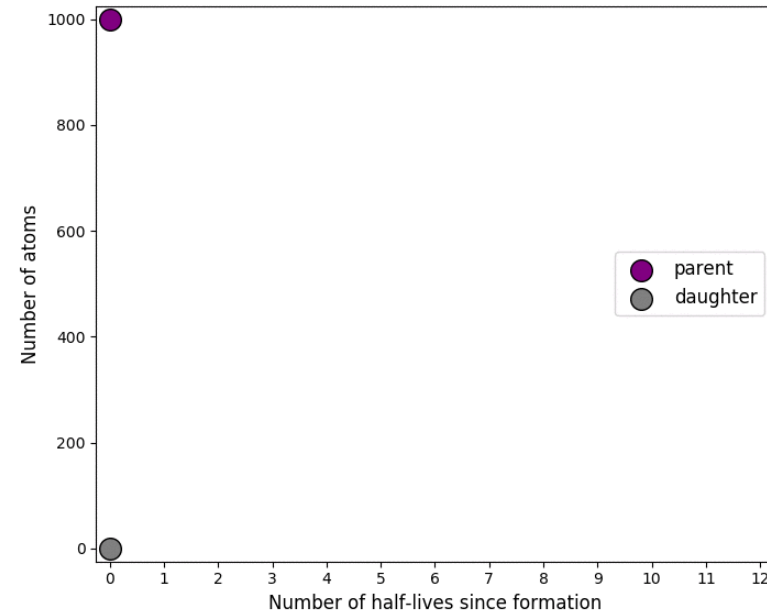
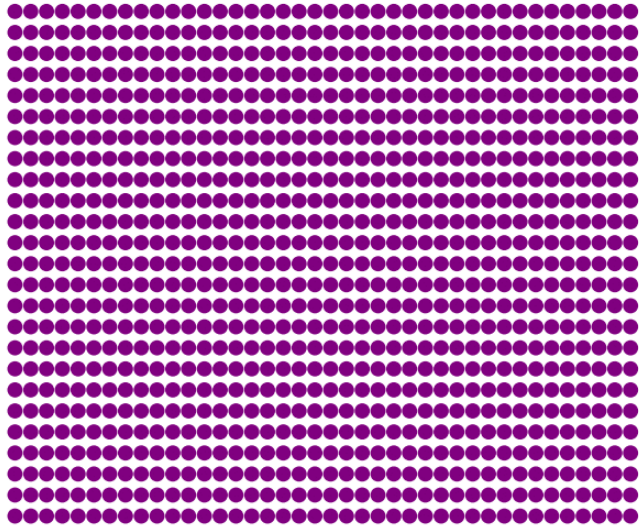
On formation: 1000 unstable parent atoms, 0 decayed daughter atoms



Radioactive
Decay

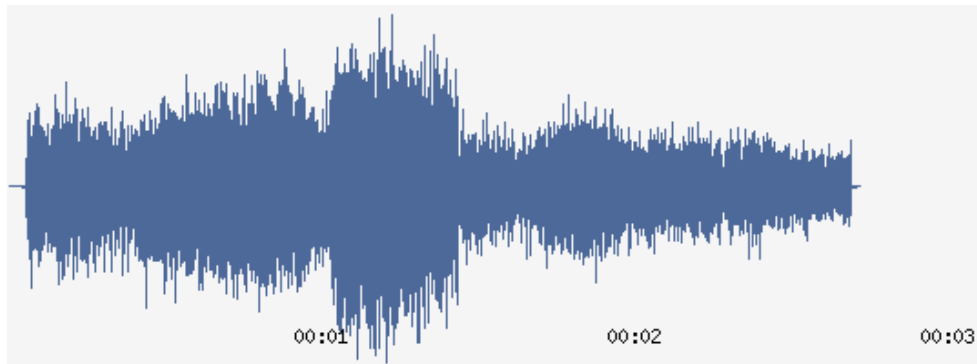
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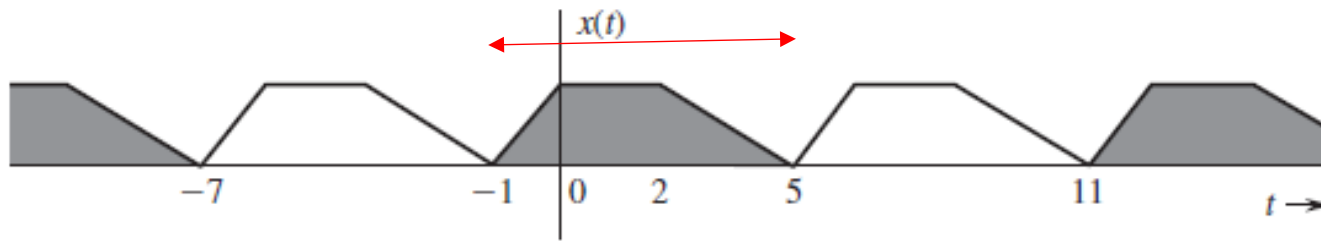
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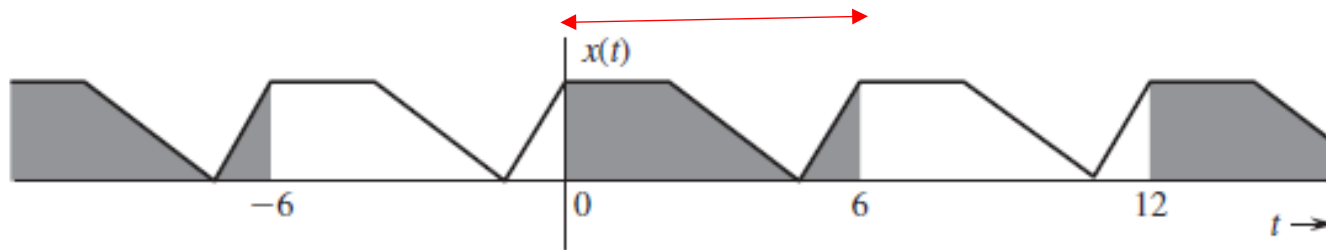
Car Crash
Recording

Periodic Signal's Time Period & Frequency

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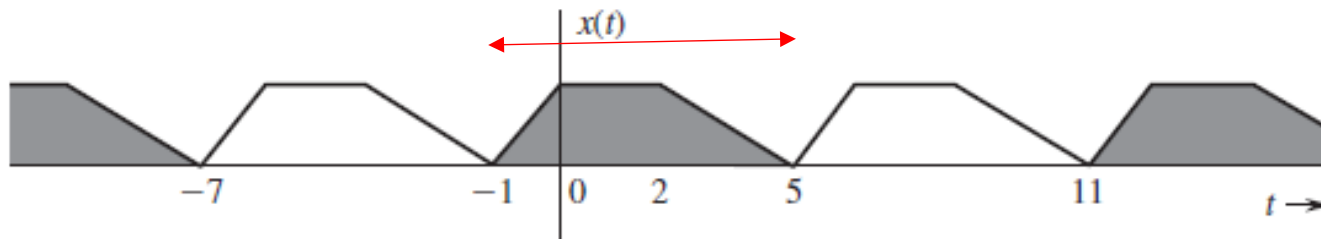


(a)



(b)

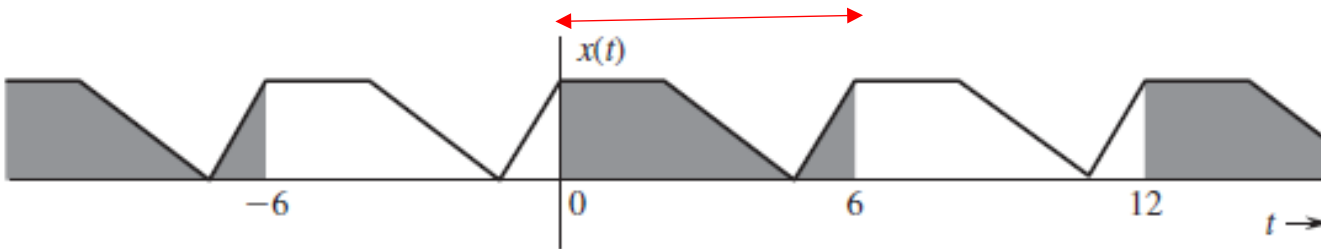
Periodic Signal's Time Period & Frequency



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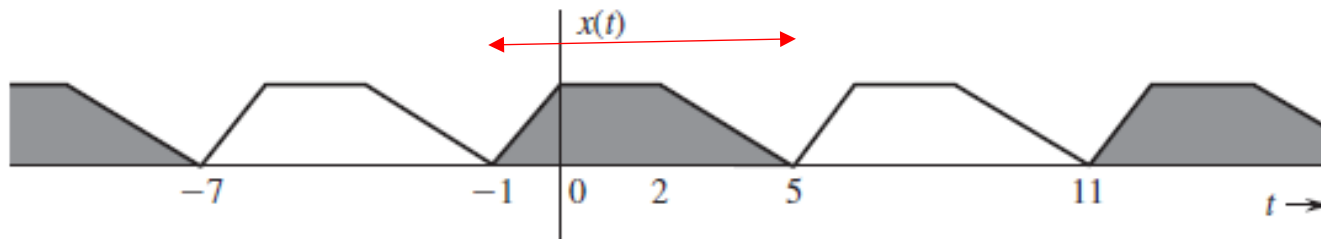
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$$f_0 = \frac{1}{T_0} = \text{fundamental frequency}$$

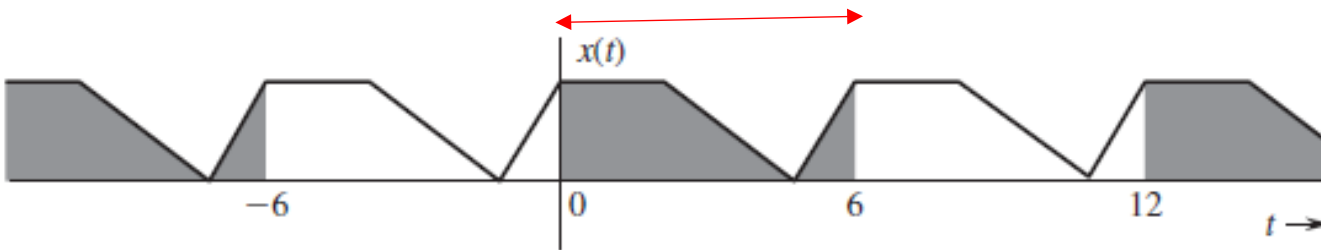


(b)

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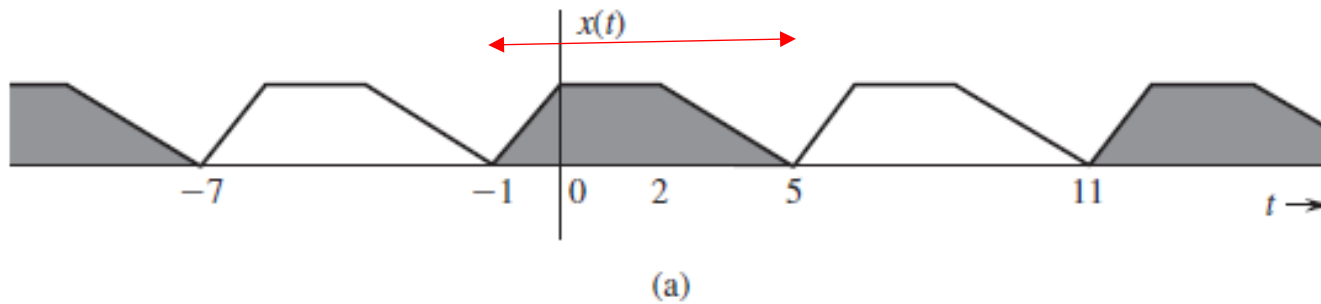
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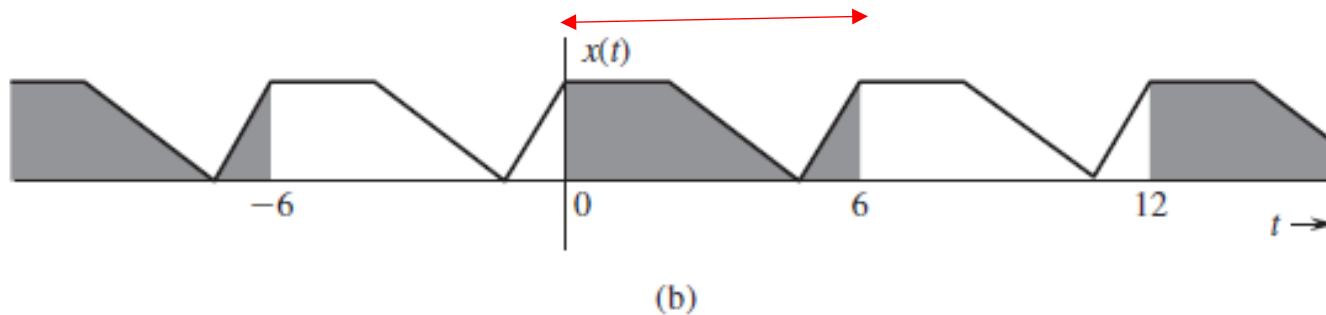
Can you write a mathematical definition of periodicity?

Periodic Signal's Time Period & Frequency



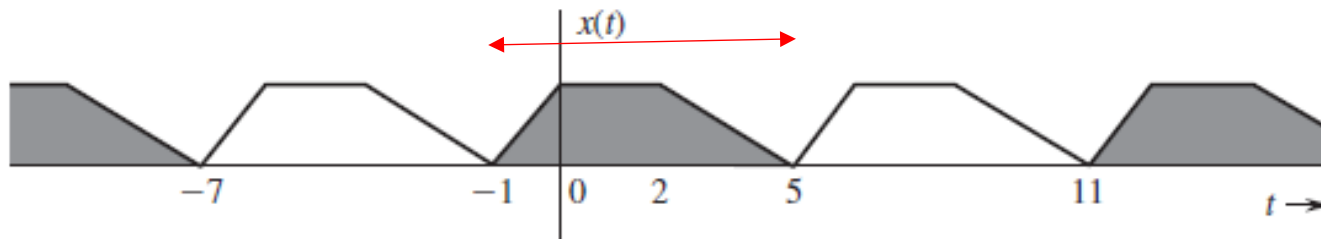
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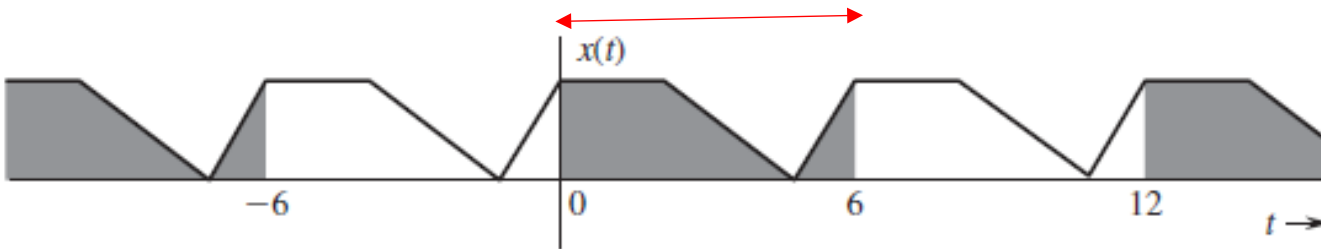


$$x(t) = x(t + T_0) \quad \text{for all } t$$

Periodic Signal's Time Period & Frequency



(a)



(b)

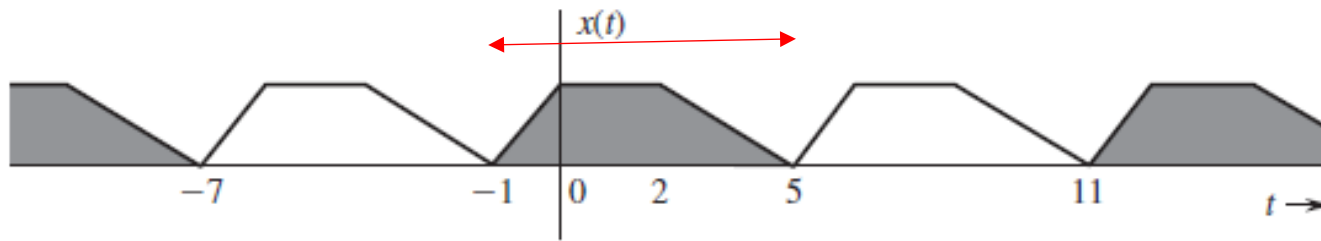
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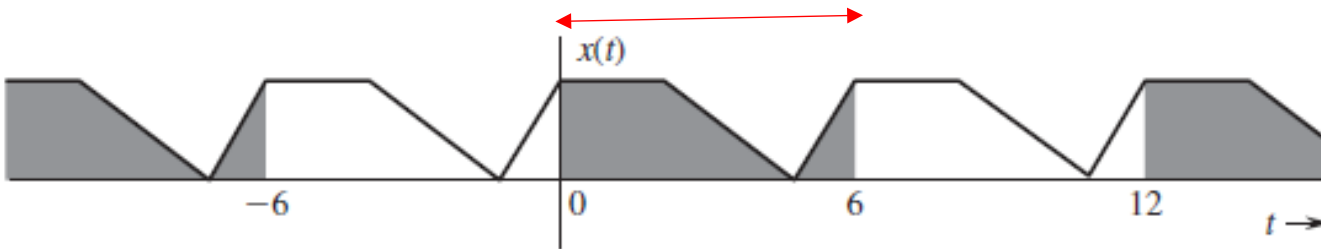
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Mathematical requirement for a function $x(t)$ to be periodic.

Periodic Signal's Time Period & Frequency



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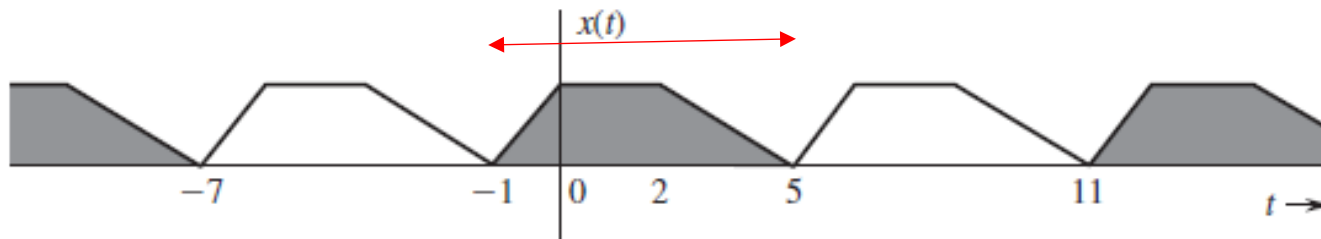


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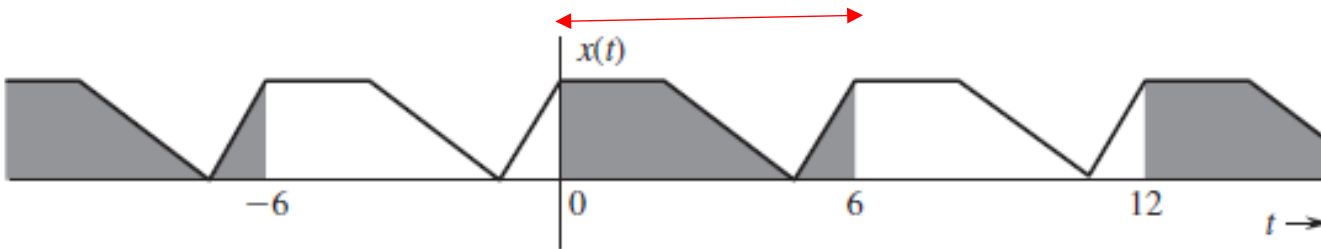
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Keep in mind that this should hold for all t !

Periodic Signal's Time Period & Frequency



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Keep in mind that this should hold for all t !

e.g., for signal to be periodic with period $T_0 = 6$, we must have

$$\begin{aligned} x(0) &= x(0 + 6) \\ x(1) &= x(1 + 6) \\ x(-1) &= x(-1 + 6) \\ &\dots \end{aligned}$$

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Therefore, $\cos(t)$ is periodic with period

$$T_0 = 2\pi$$

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Q.E.D

ω_0 vs. f_0

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ω_0 vs. f_0

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ω_0 vs. f_0

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- ω_0 is called “angular frequency” and is given in radians/second.

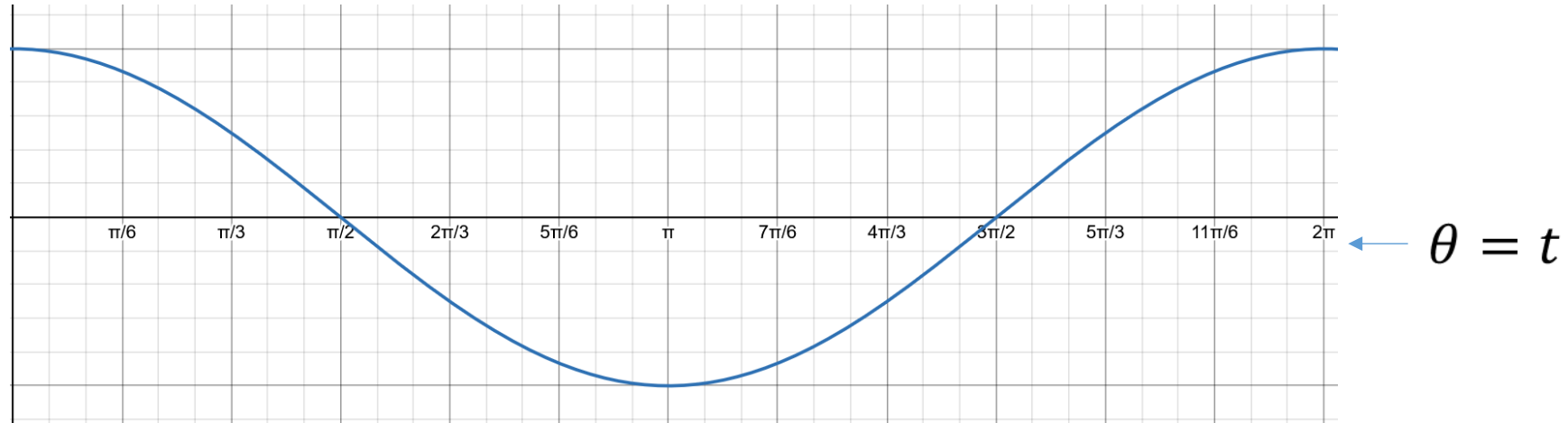
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← $\theta = t$

As time goes from 0 to 2π , the angle θ also goes from 0 to 2π , and $\cos(t)$ completes one cycle.

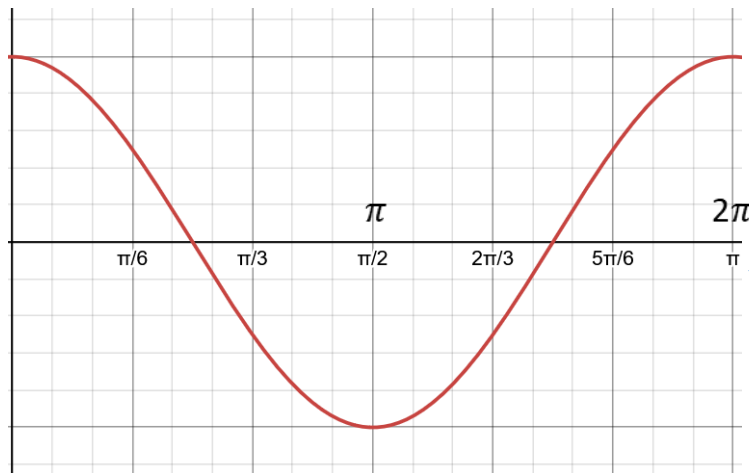
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$\theta = 2t$
 t

$\cos(2t)$ has period $T_0 = \pi$ and frequency $f_0 = 1/\pi$

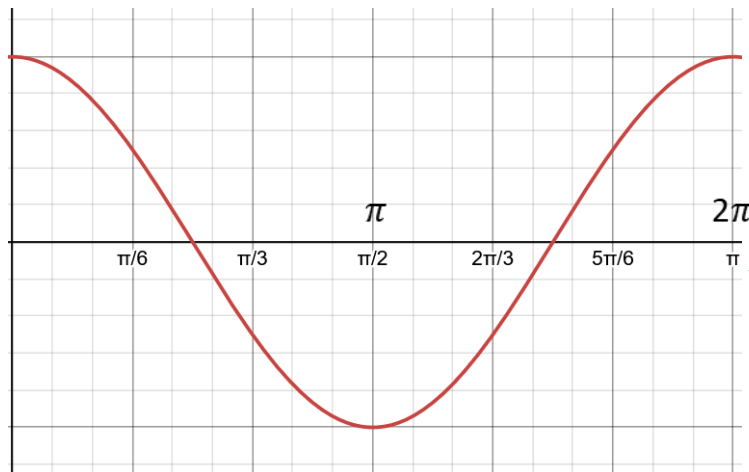
Visualizing relation between t and θ

$\cos(t)$ has period $T_0 = 2\pi$ and frequency $f_0 = 1/2\pi$



$\theta = t$

As time goes from 0 to 2π , the angle θ also goes from 0 to 2π , and $\cos(t)$ completes one cycle.



$\theta = 2t$
 t

$\cos(2t)$ has period $T_0 = \pi$ and frequency $f_0 = 1/\pi$

As time goes from 0 to π , the angle θ goes from 0 to 2π , thus $\cos(2t)$ completes one cycle much faster.

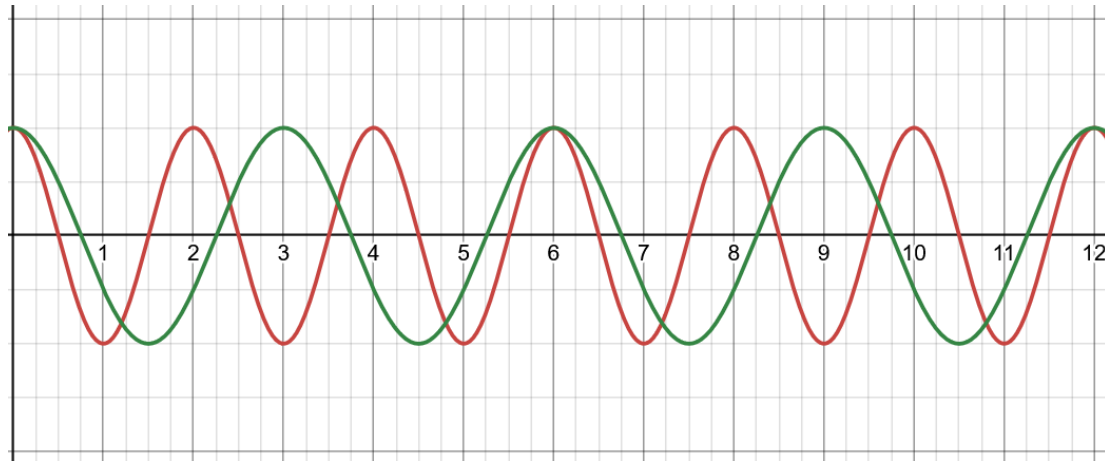
Q. Is the sum of periodic signals always periodic?

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Example
1

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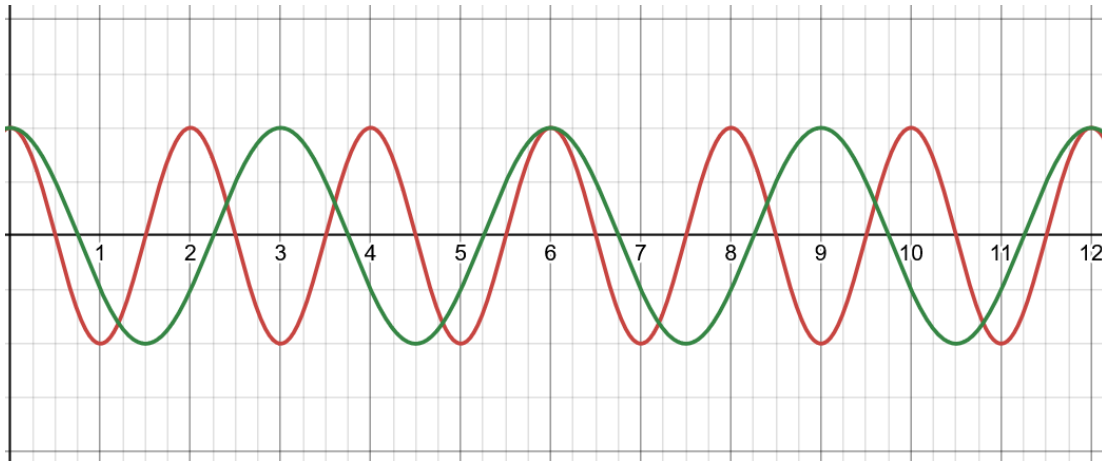
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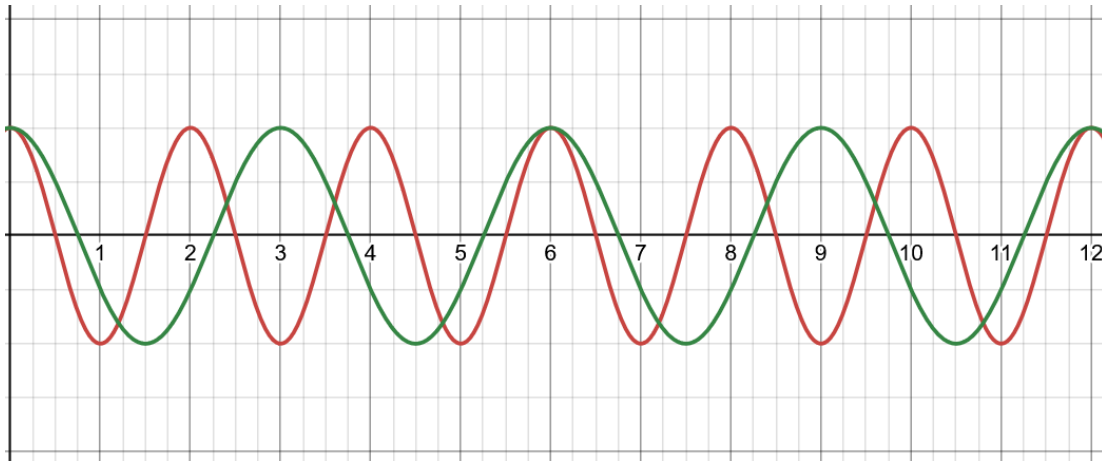


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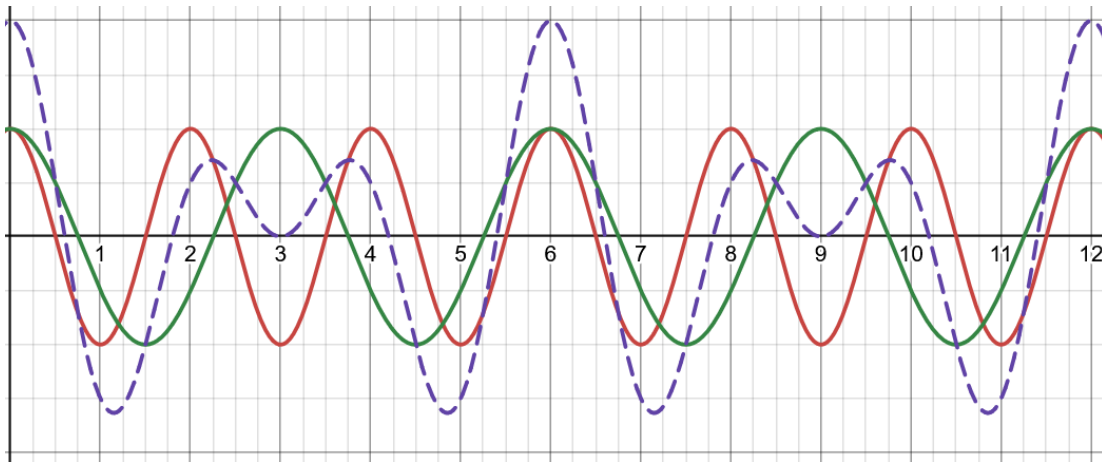
$$- T_1 = 2, T_2 = 3$$

Q. Is the sum of periodic signals always periodic?

Example 1

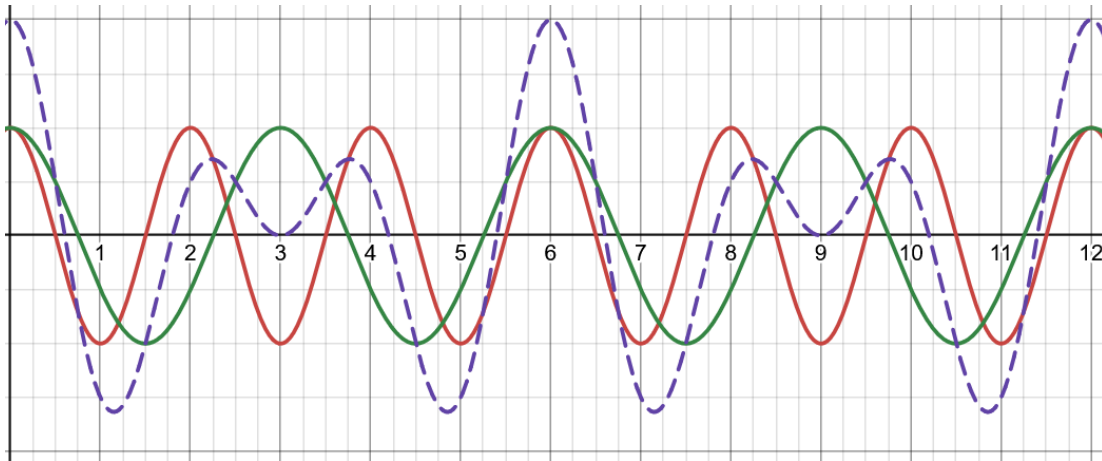
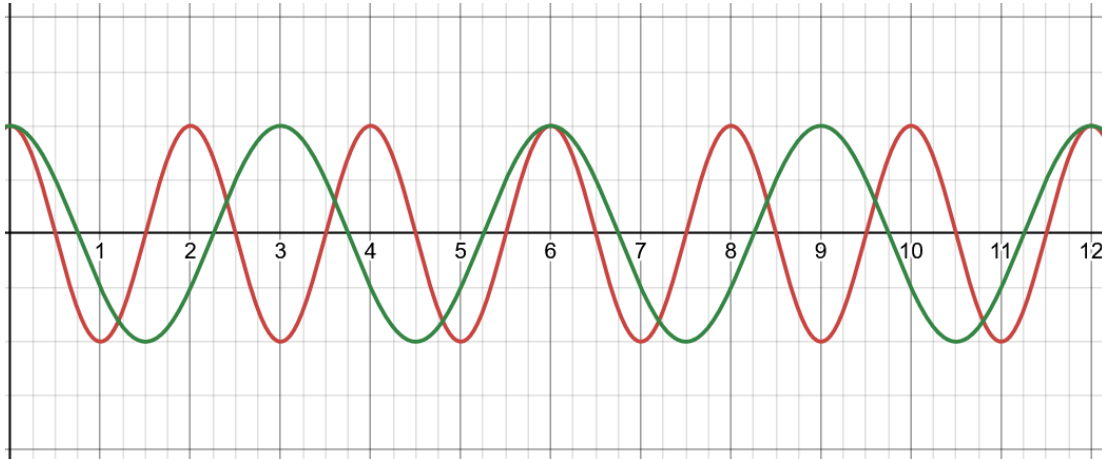


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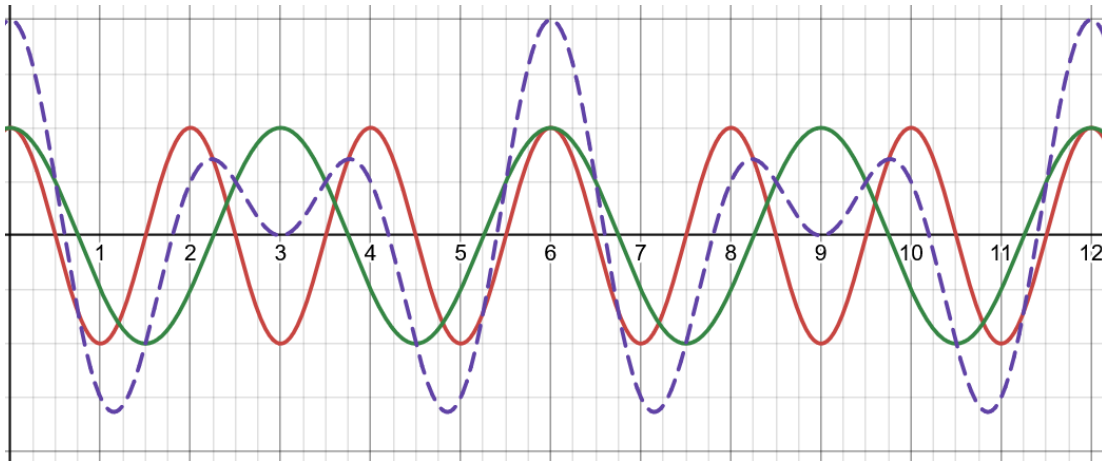
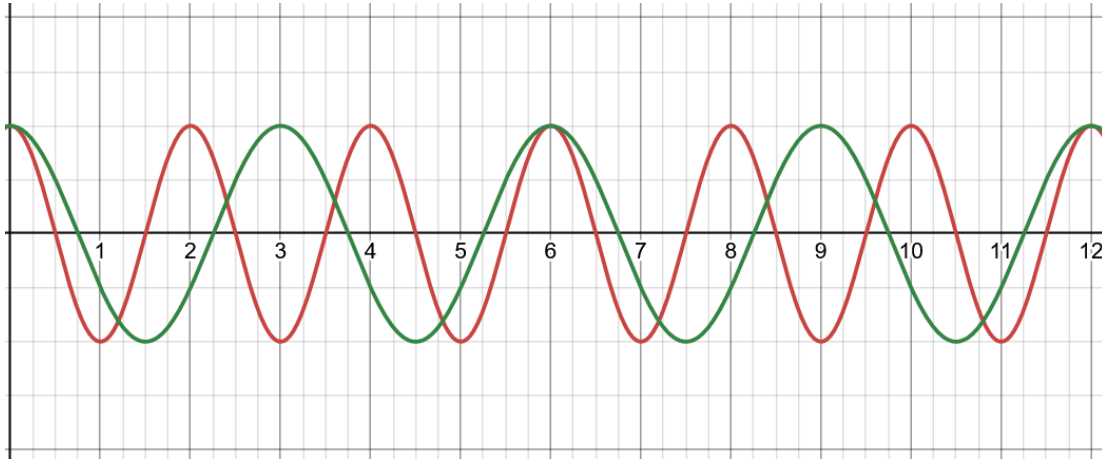
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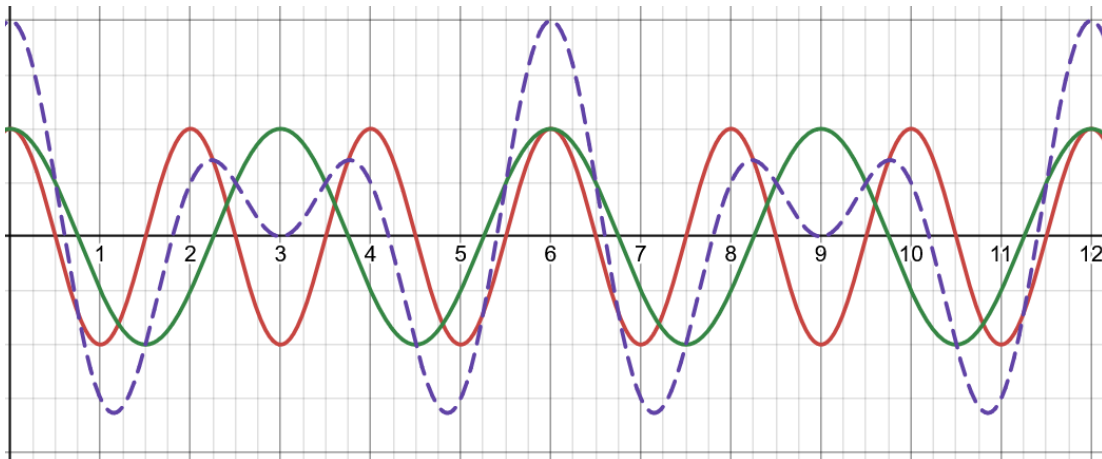
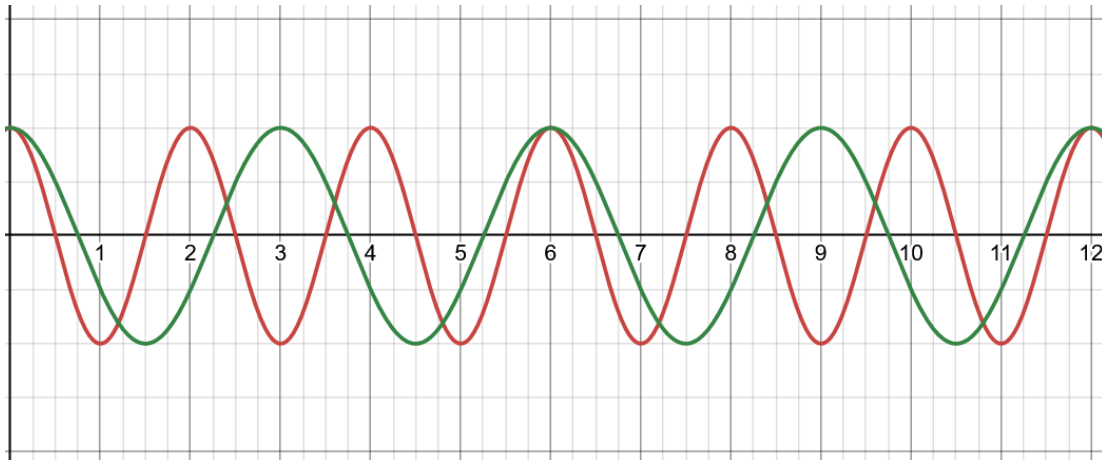
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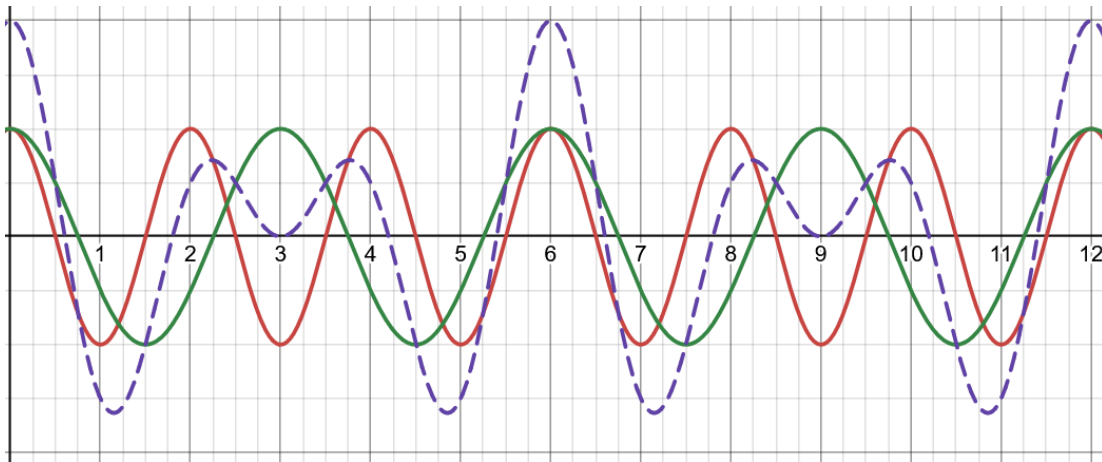
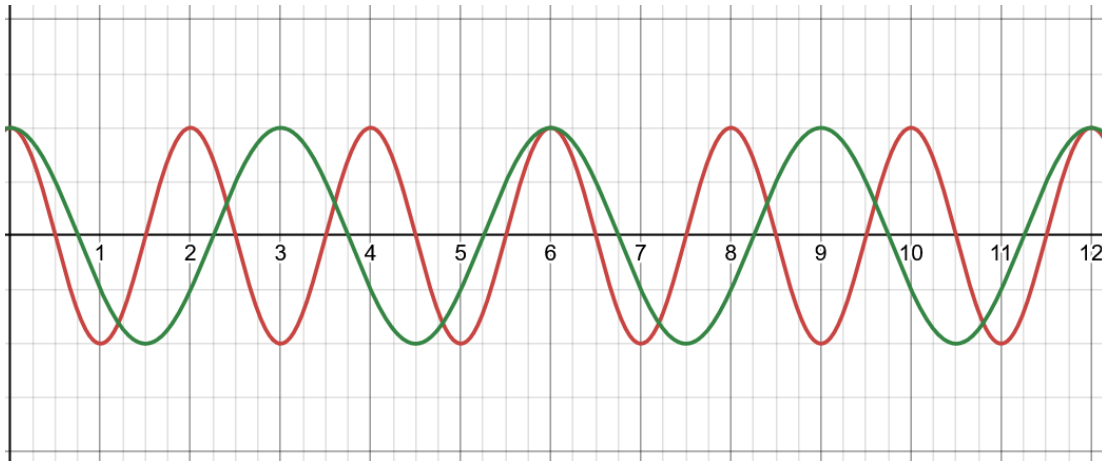
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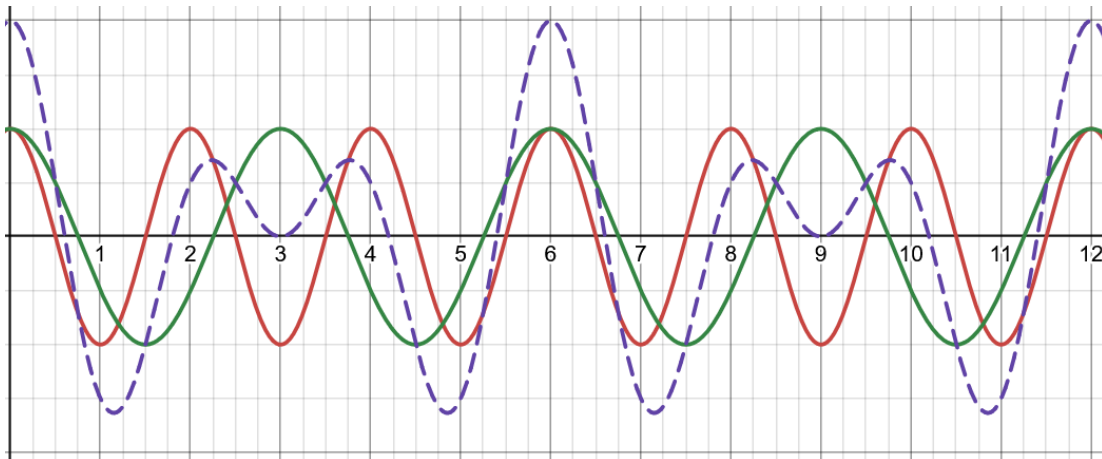
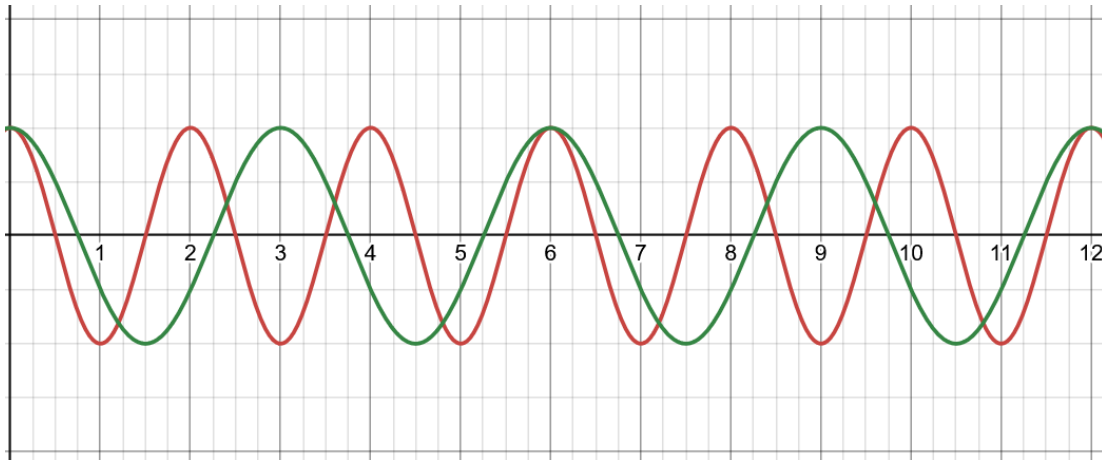
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At 6, their cycles match (one has completed three cycles and other has completed two)

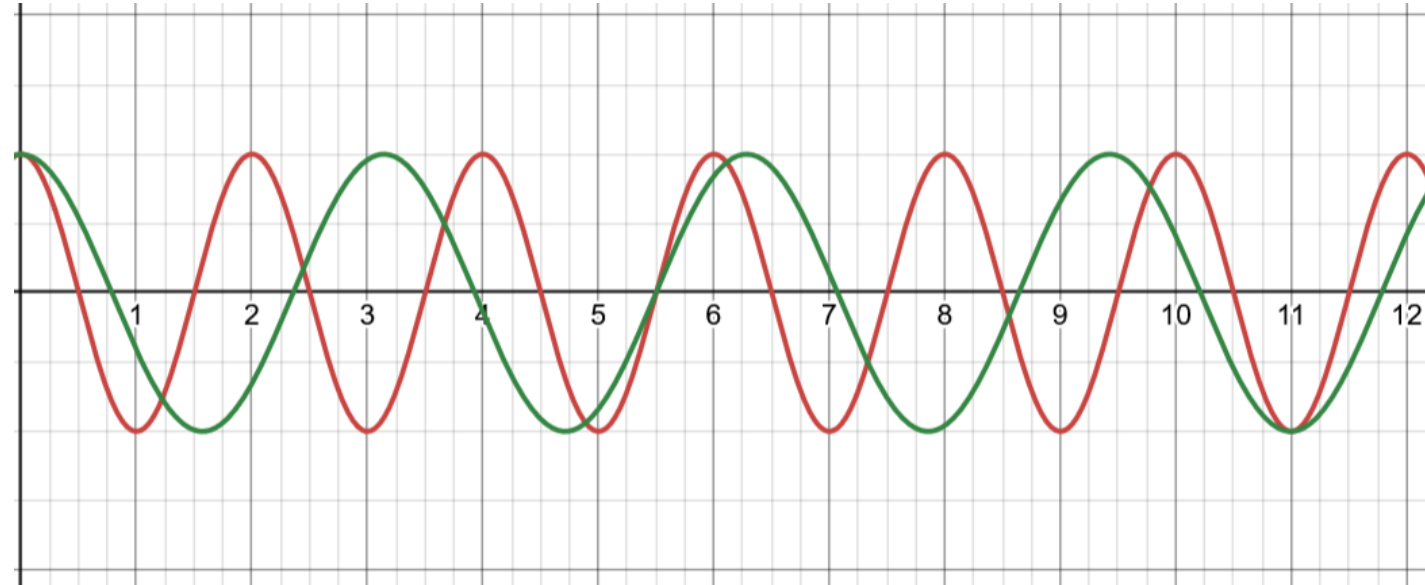
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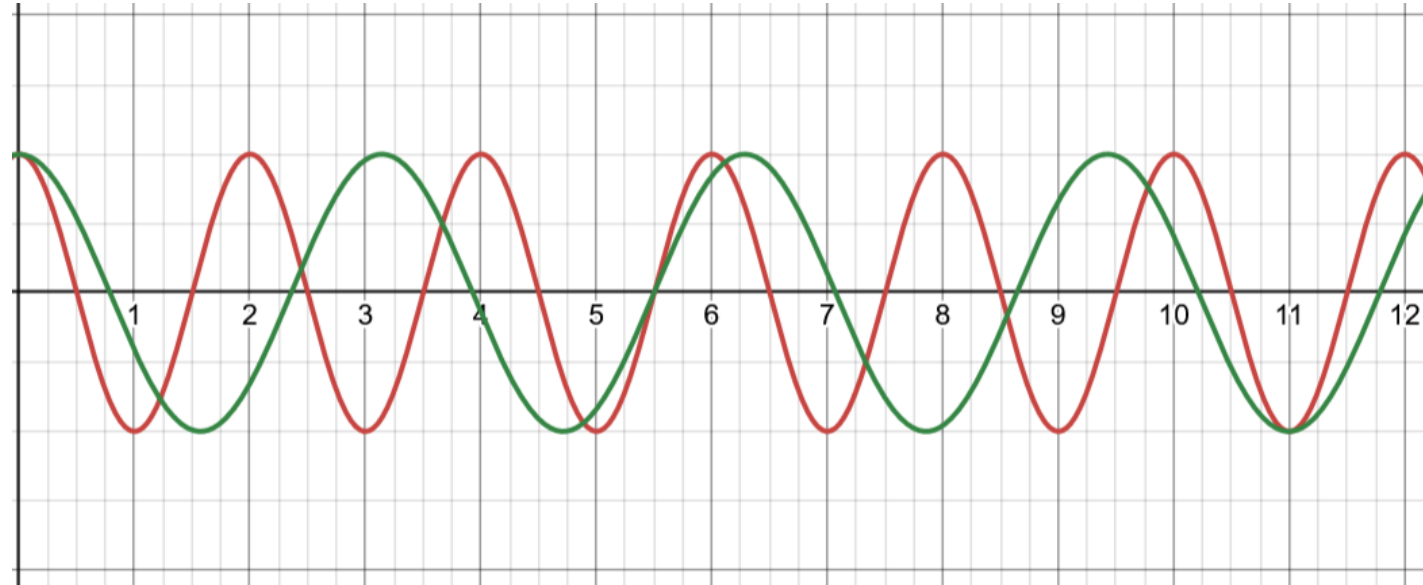
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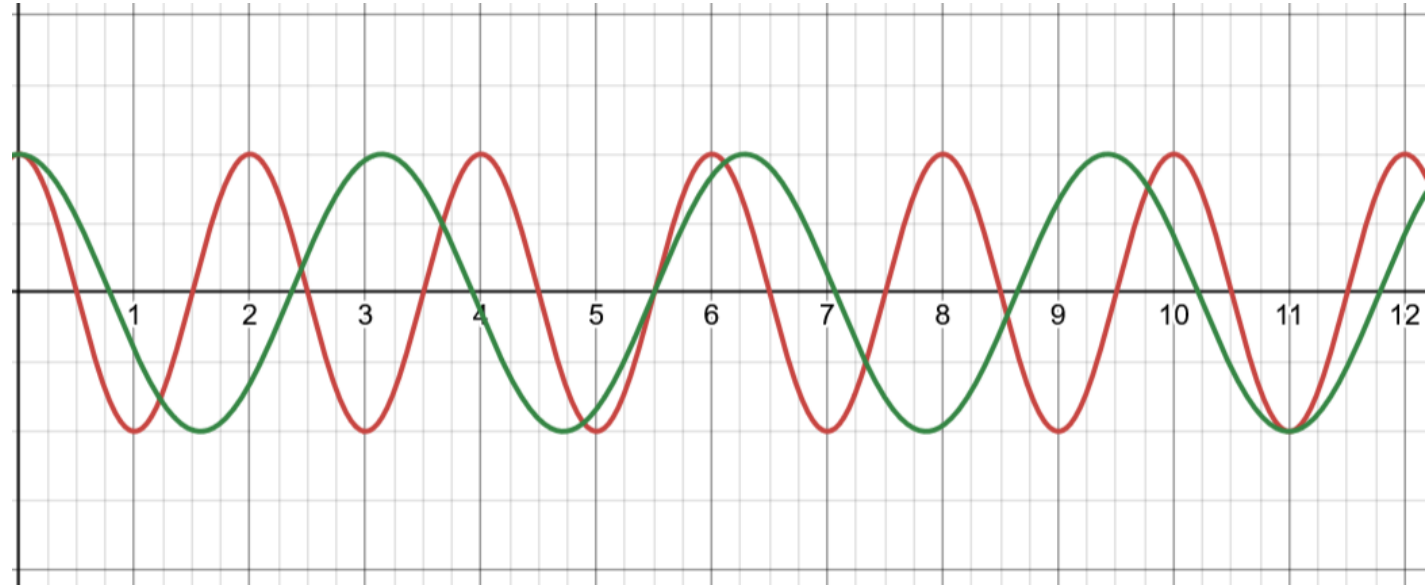
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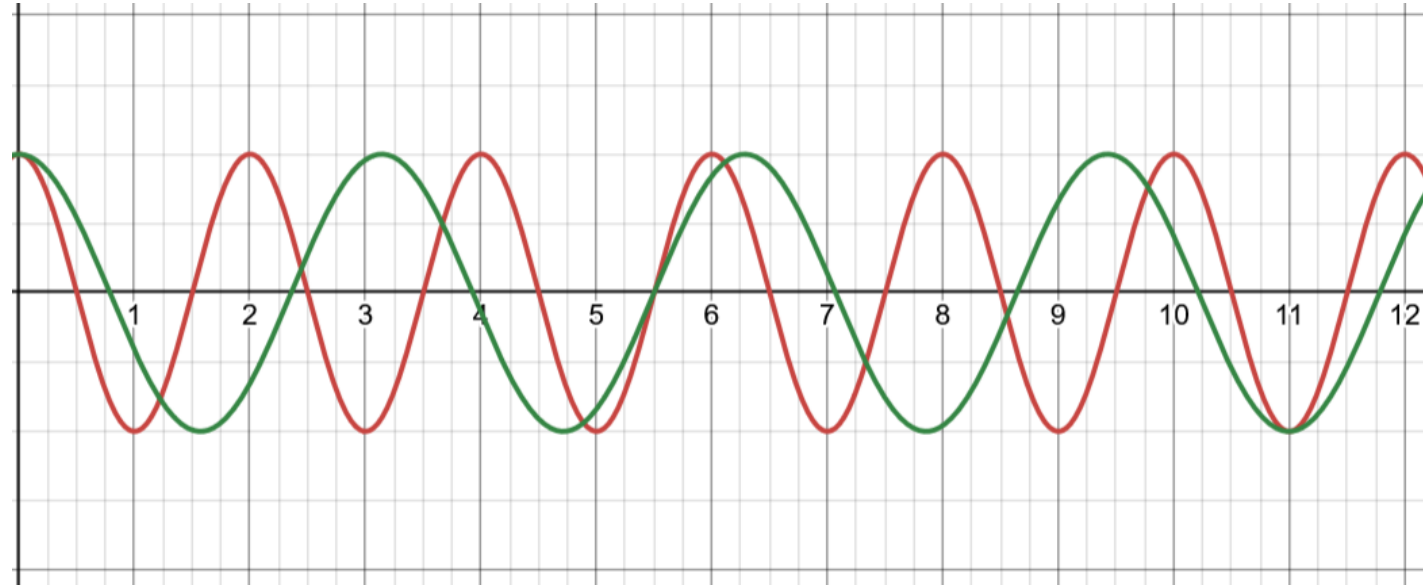
- What if the signals had period $T_1 = 2$ and $T_2 = \pi$, would their sum be periodic?
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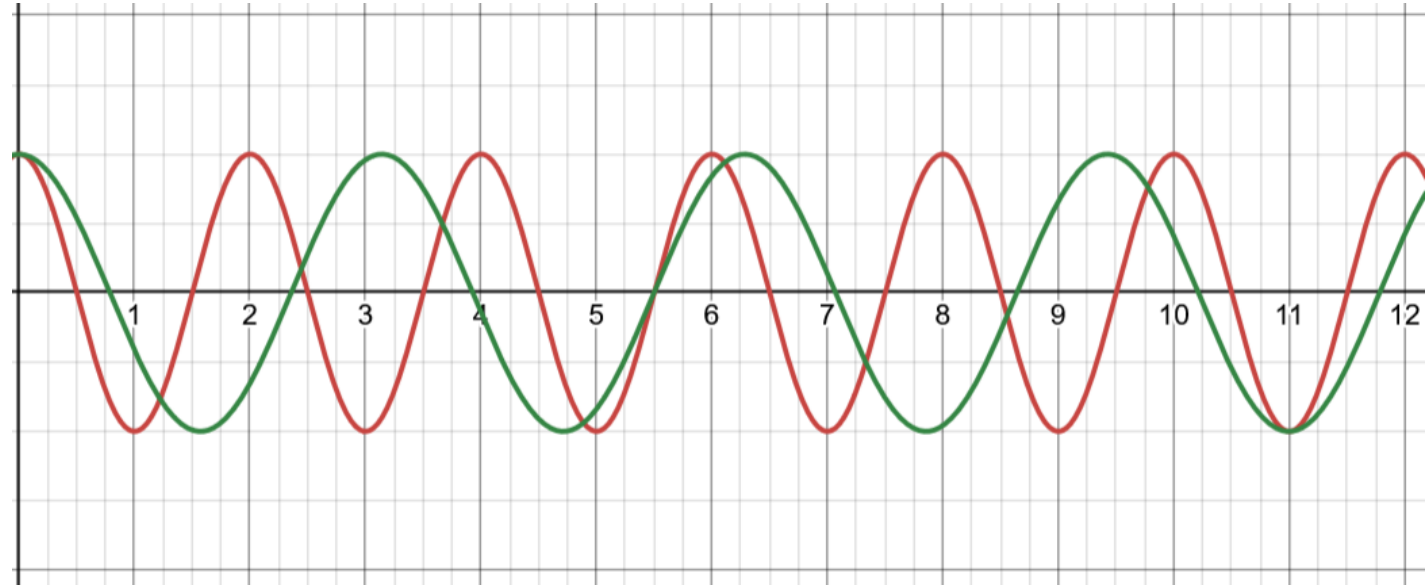


Recall that LCM of a, b is the smallest positive number L such that L/a and L/b are both integers.

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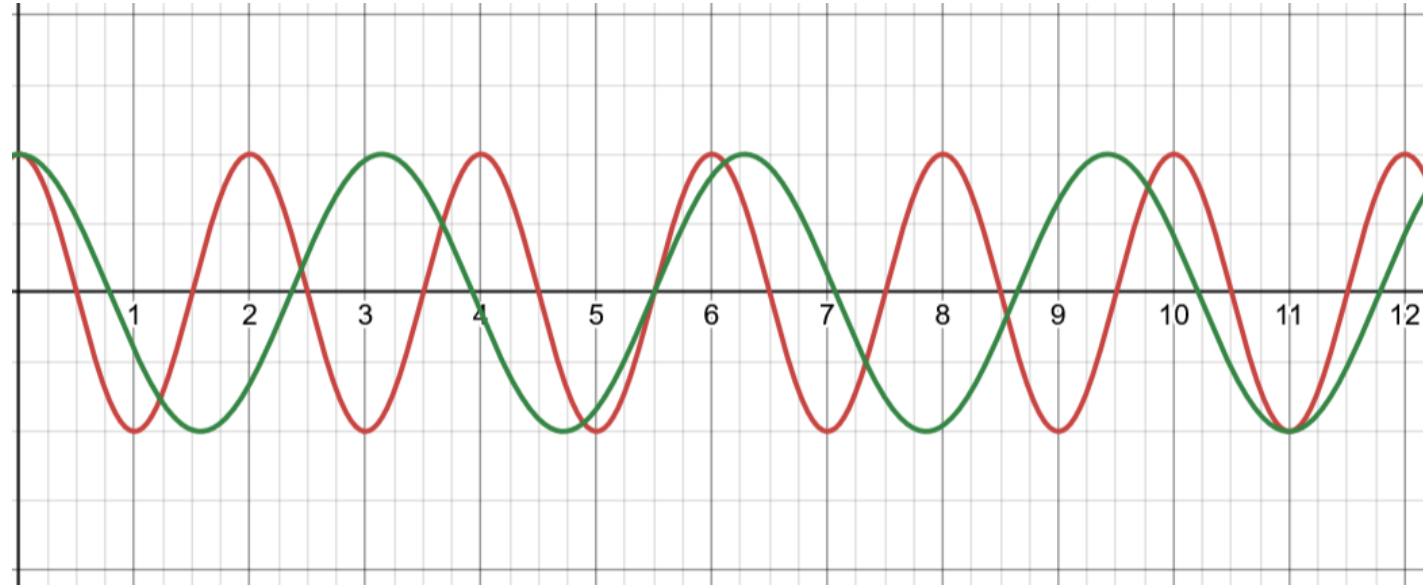


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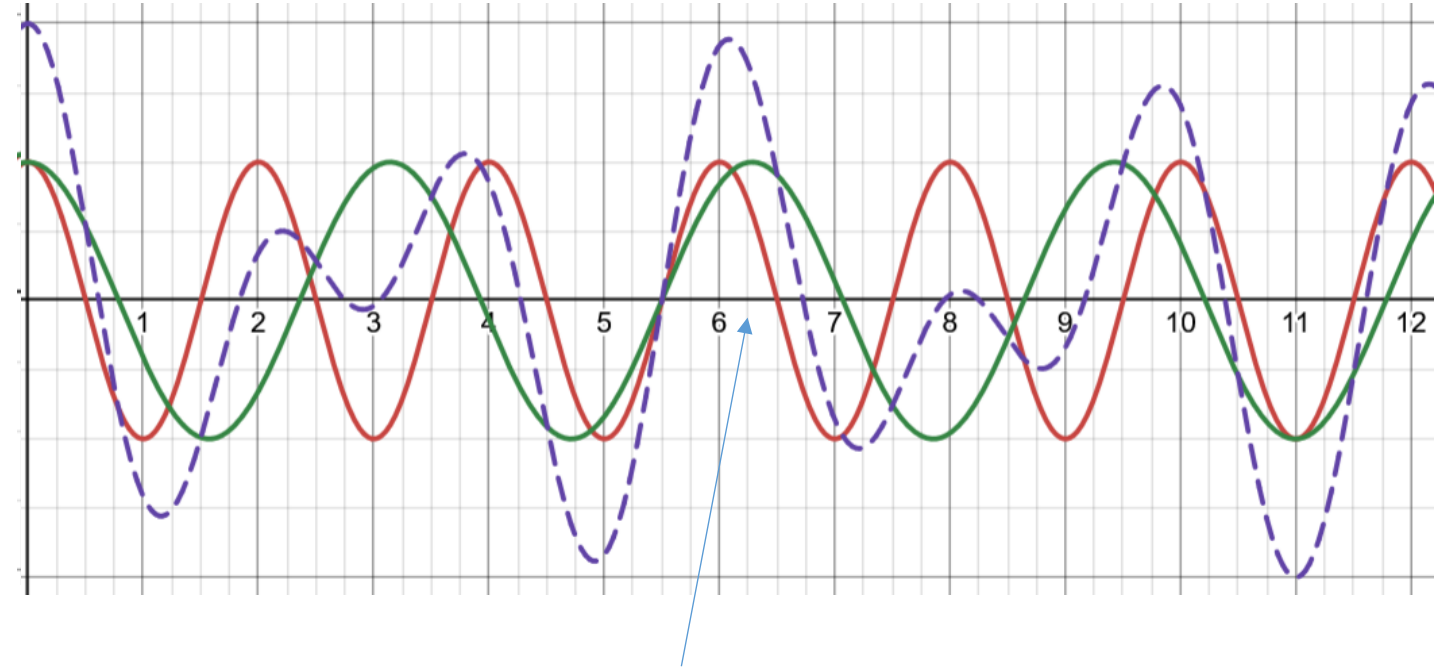
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Even at 2π seconds, x_2 would have completed two cycles, while x_1 would have completed three cycles and part of the fourth cycle.

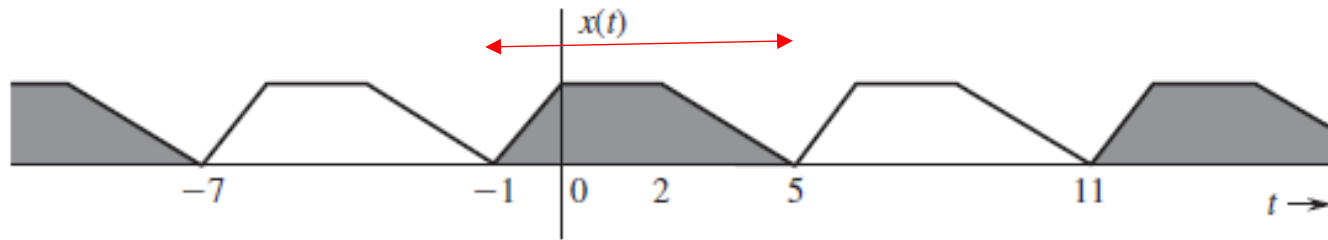
Lesson: sum of two periodic signals is periodic if and only if ratio of their time periods is rational.

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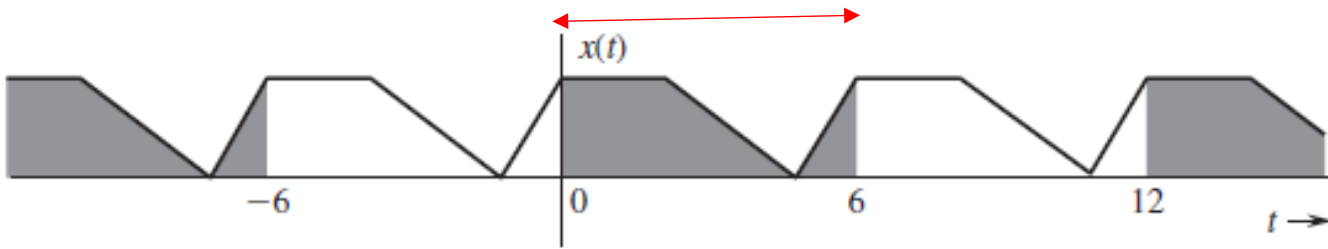
- In this case LCM of their periods exists
- And $T_{sum} = LCM(T_1, T_2)$

Periodic Signal : Interesting Property

Area under one whole period of a periodic signal is always the same no matter where you start!!



(a)

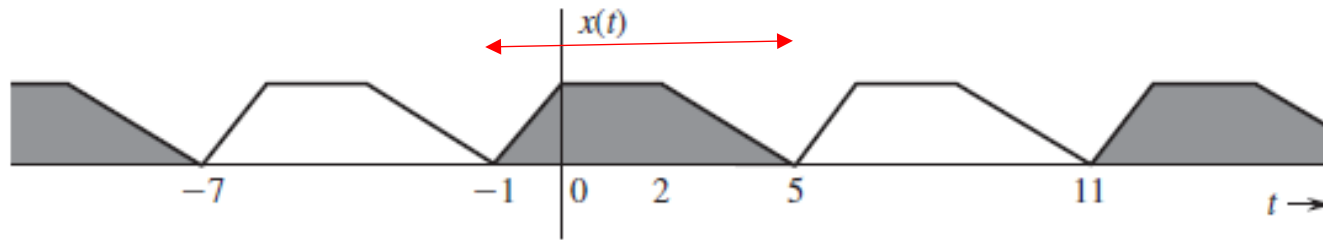


(b)

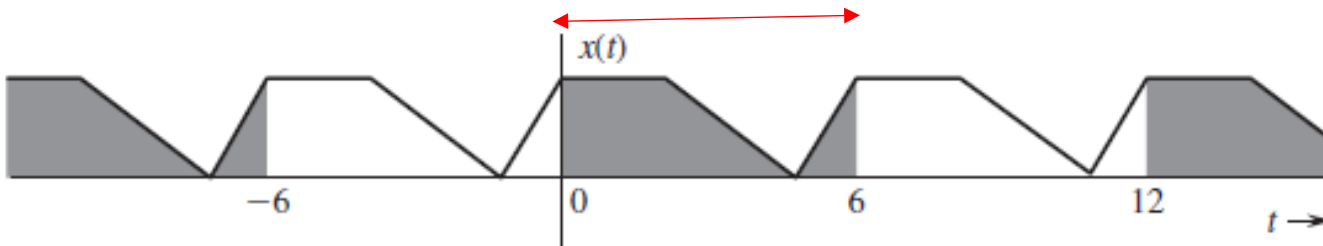
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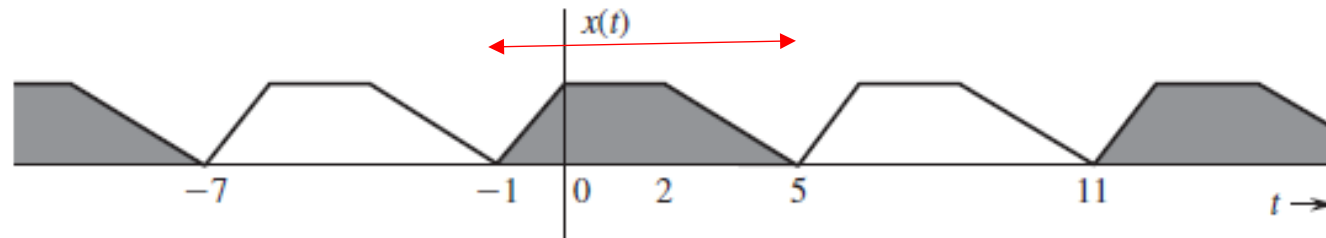


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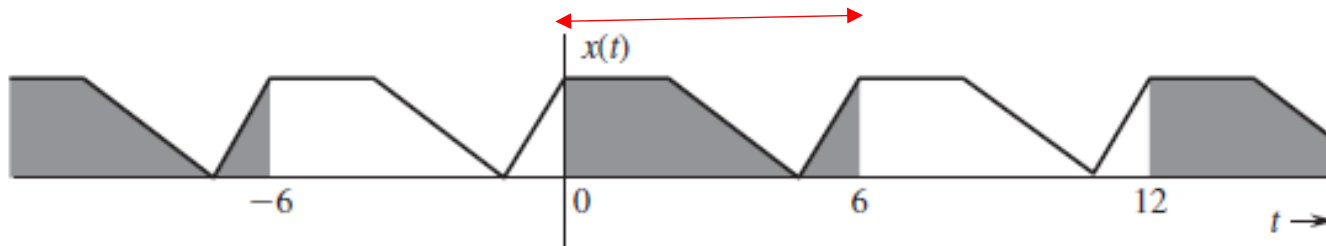
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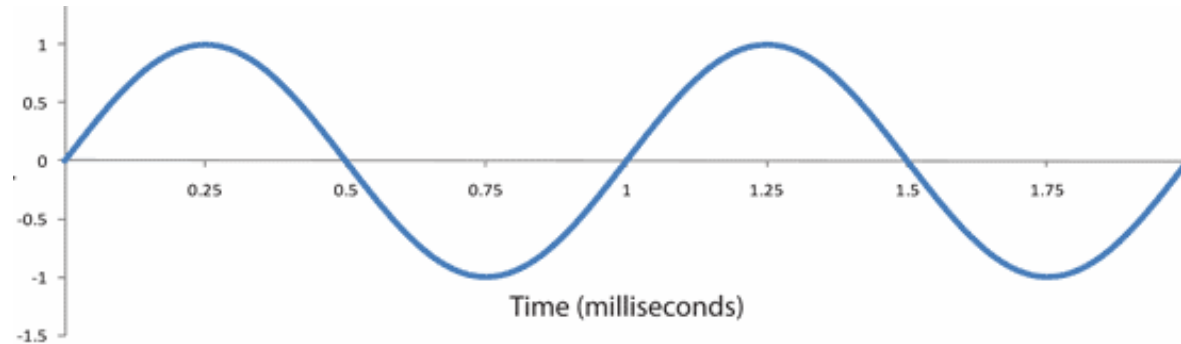
(b)

$$\int_a^{a+T_0} x(t) dt = \int_b^{b+T_0} x(t) dt$$

4. Are the Signal Values/Parameters Random?

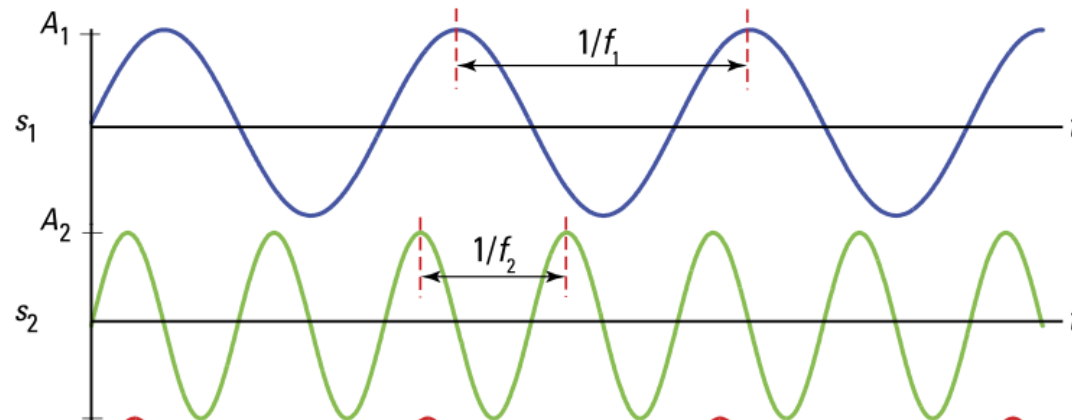
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“Deterministic”



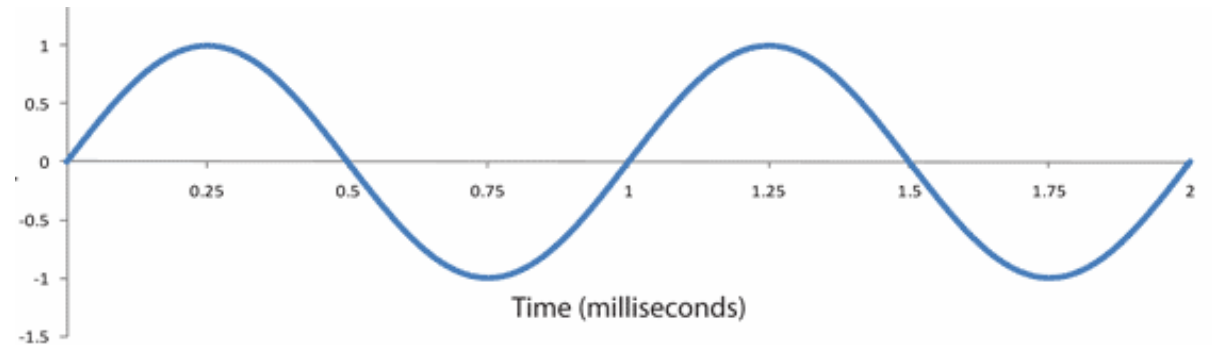
Vs.

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$$x(t) = \sin(2\pi ft) \text{ with } f = 1 \text{ kHz}$$

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Value of f to be decided by tossing a coin

$$f = \begin{cases} 1, & \text{Heads} \\ 2, & \text{Tails} \end{cases}$$



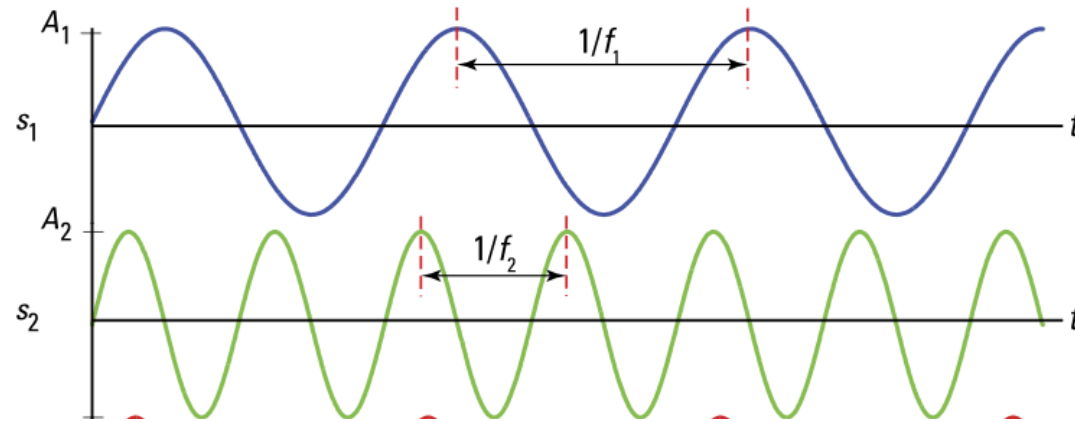
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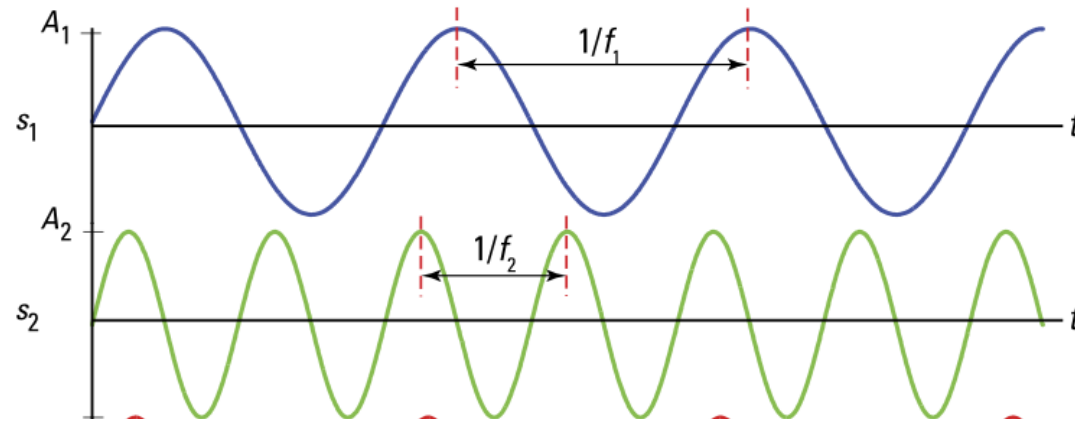
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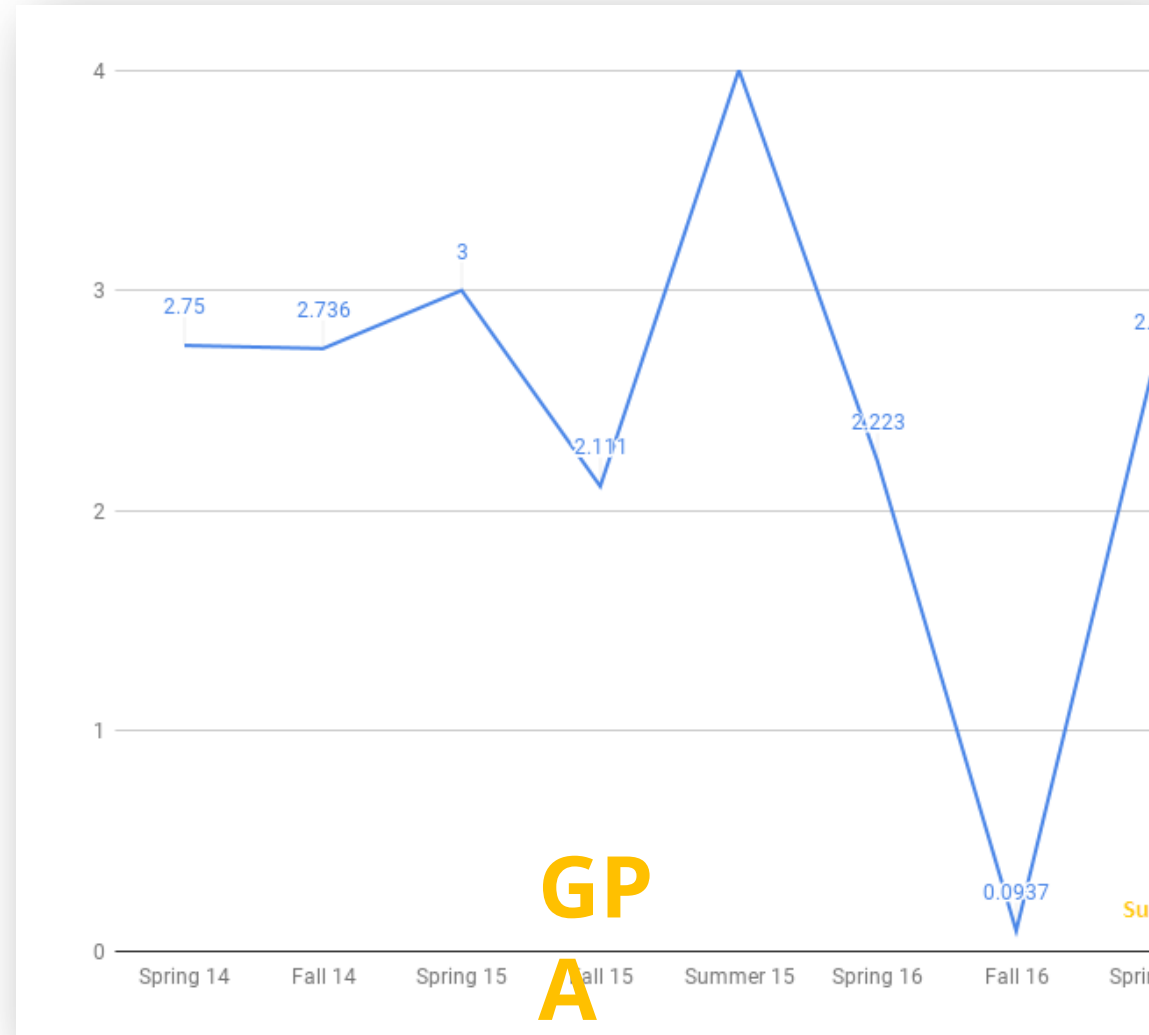


Or, we could have random variations in frequency and/or amplitude...



Can you think
of a random
signal?

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5. Does the signal have finite energy or finite Power?

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For that, we will first need to answer the following...

- What are energy and power of a signal?
- Why are they needed?

*Measures are
important...*

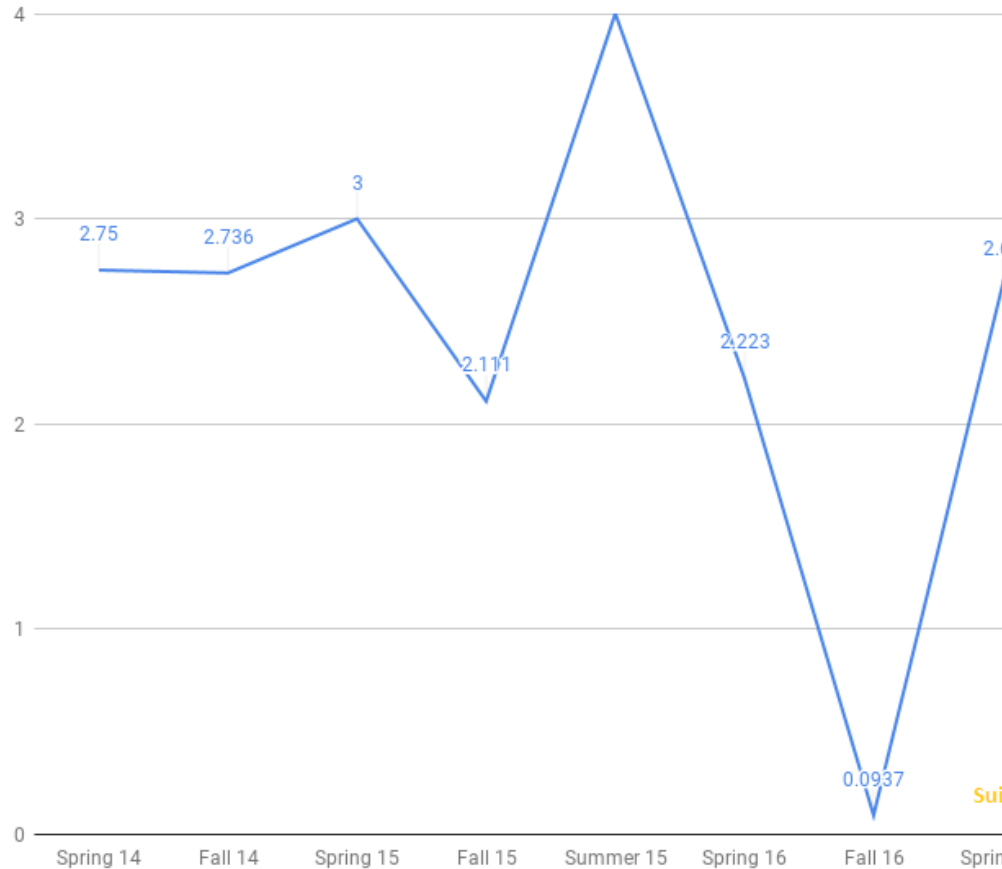
Height, Age, GDP, Stock
Index...

Q. How can we measure a signal?

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We often find it useful to look at just one value that gives the overall effect of a signal.

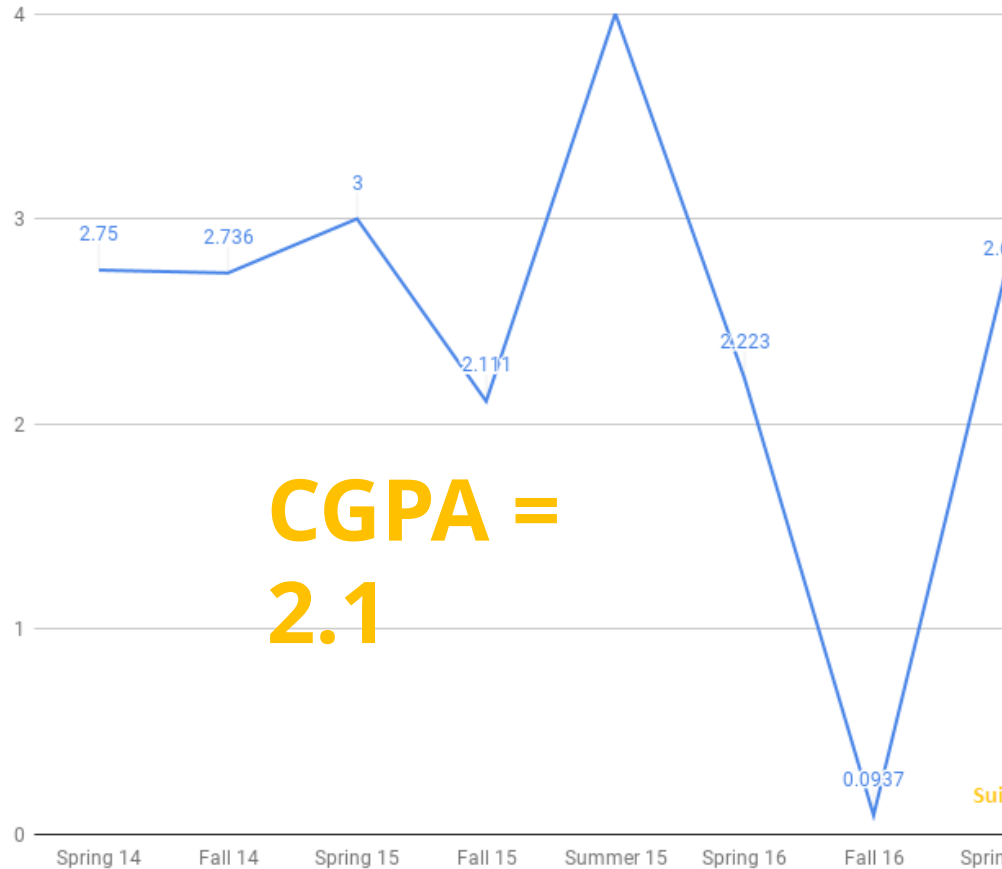
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Signal Energy is the area under the absolute square of the signal.

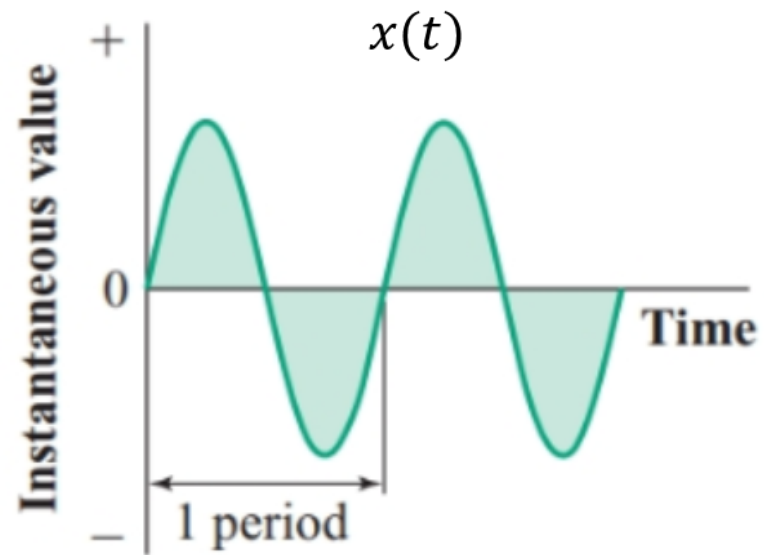
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Signal Energy

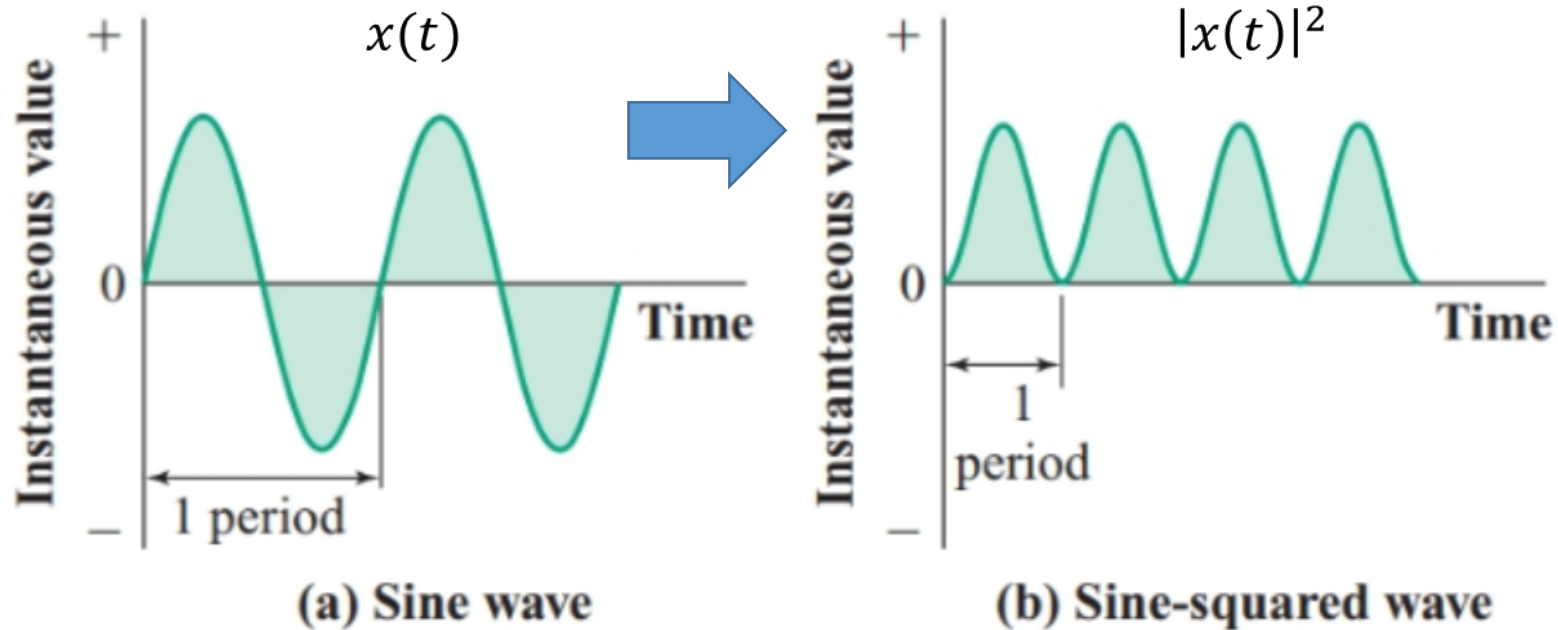
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(a) Sine wave

Signal Energy

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Hint: apply second "definition" to this signal...

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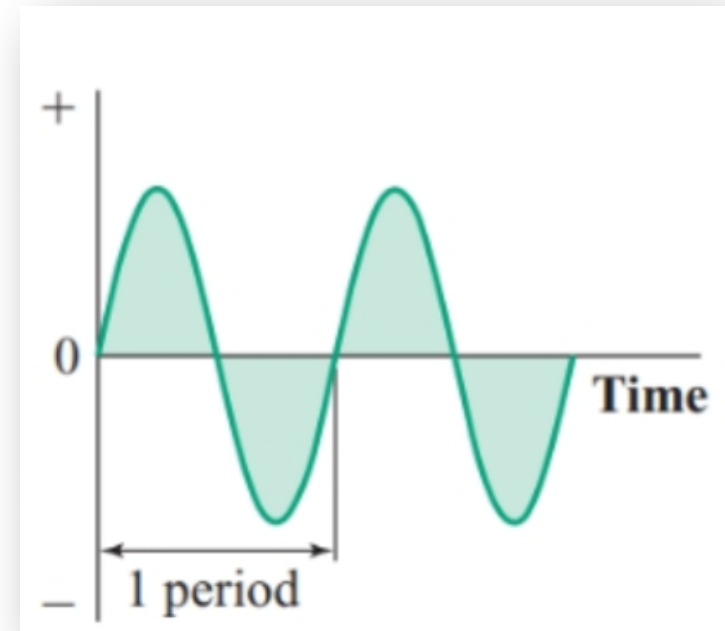
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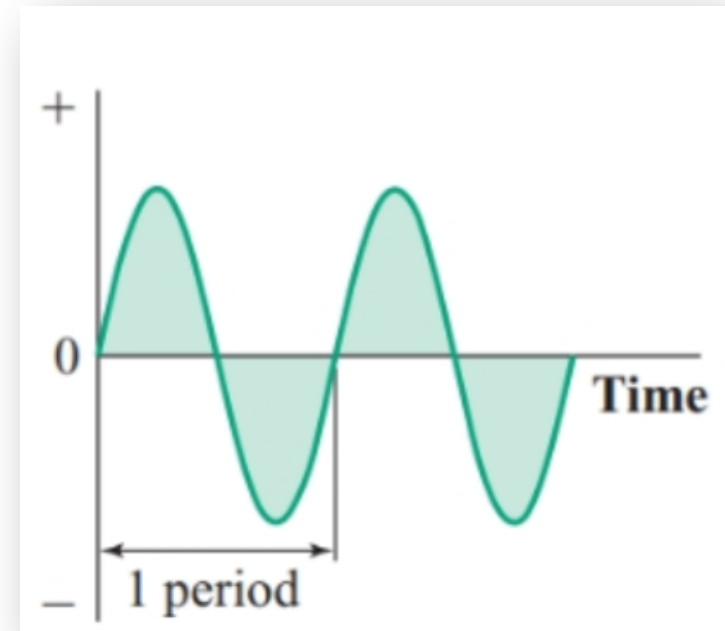
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Hint: apply second "definition" to this signal...

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(t) dt = 0$$



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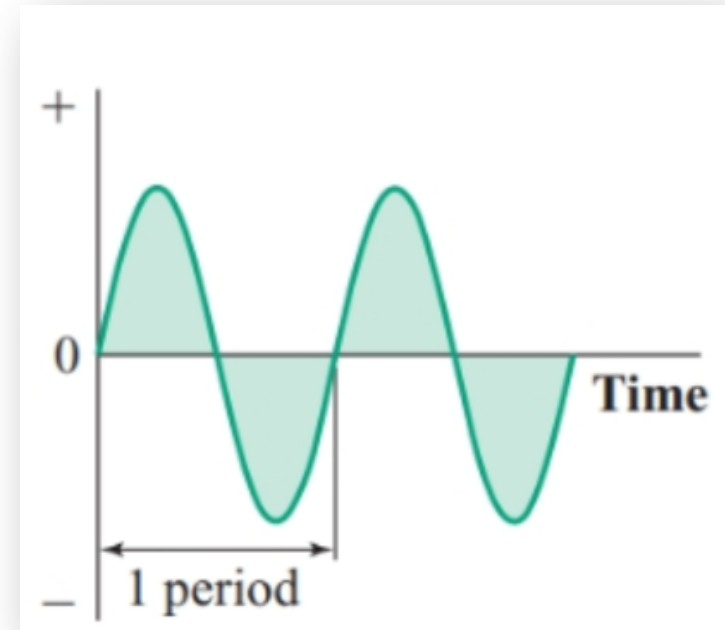
$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |x(t)|^2 dt$$

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(t) dx$$

Hint: apply second "definition" to this signal...

For many signals, area under the signal curve will turn out to be zero. So not a good way of measuring signals.

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(t) dt = 0$$



Energy Signal

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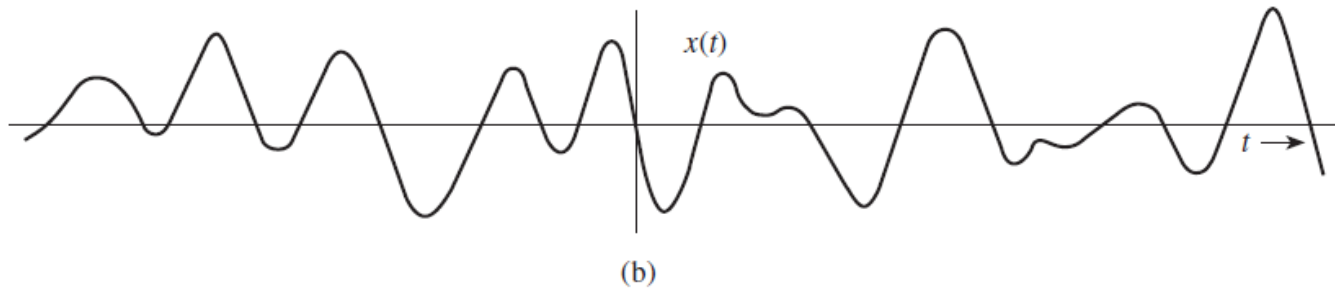
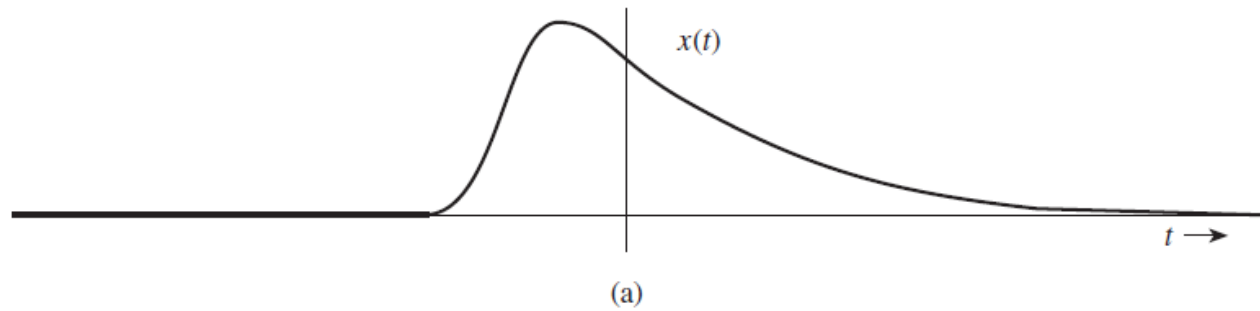
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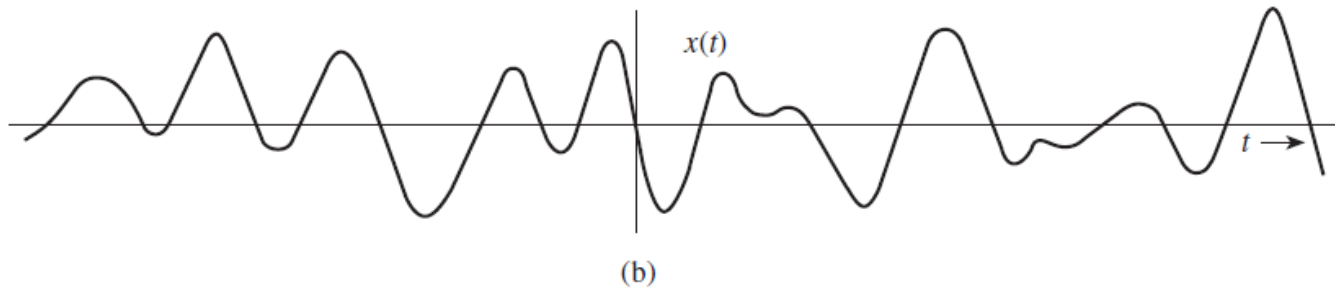
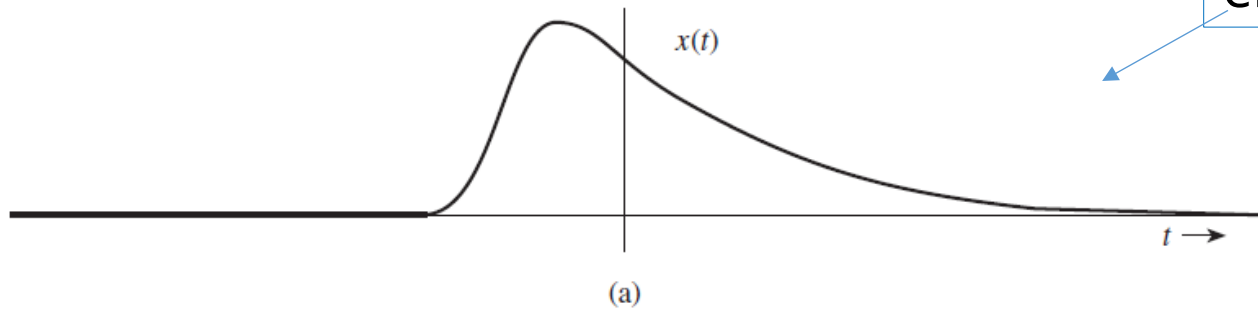
$$E_x = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |x(t)|^2 dt \neq \infty$$

Q. Which of these have finite energy (assuming $t \rightarrow \infty$)?

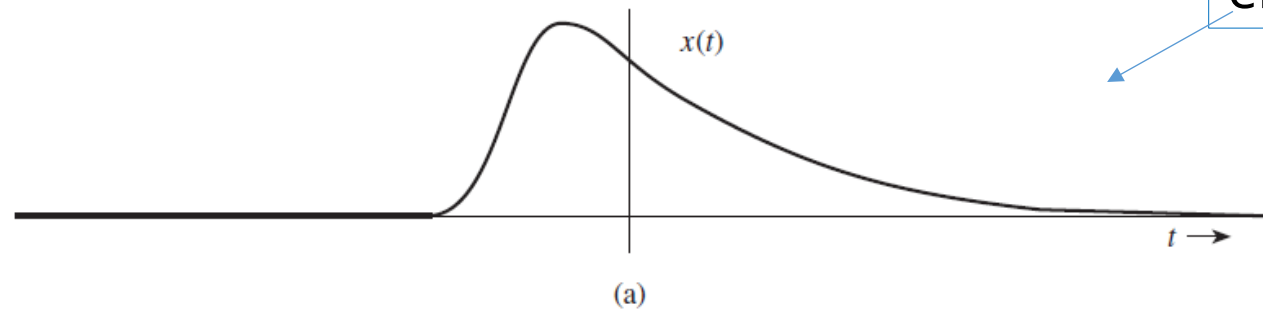


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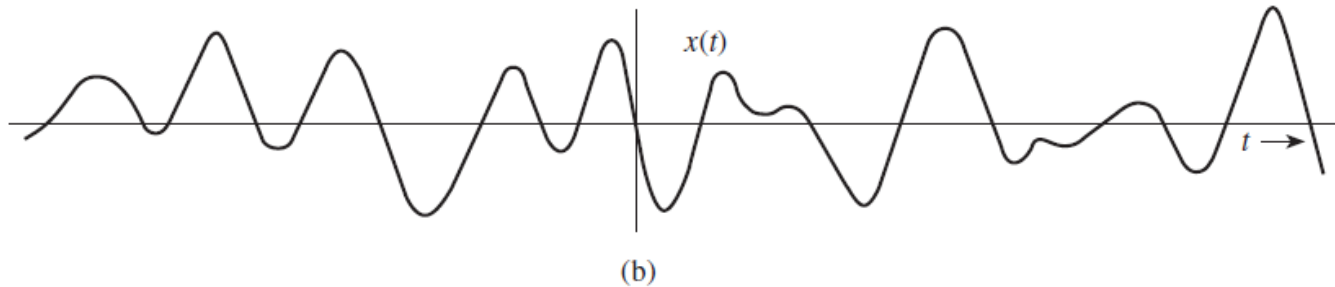
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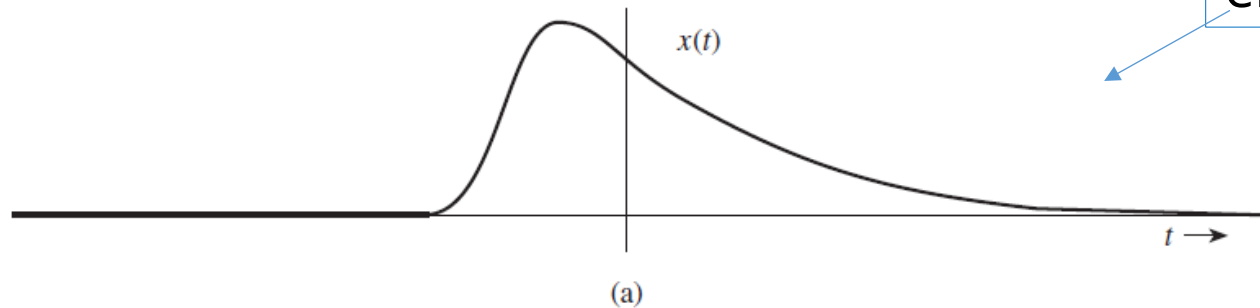


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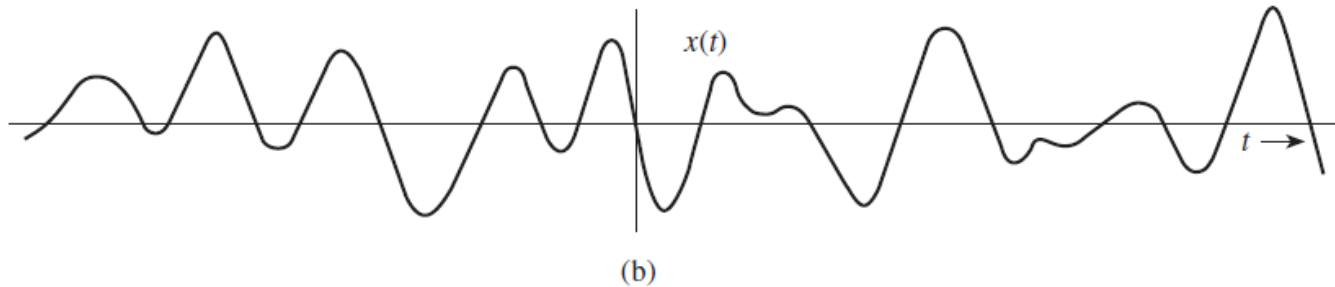


This is not an “energy signal” as it has infinite energy.

Q. Which of these have finite energy (assuming $t \rightarrow \infty$)?



This is an “energy signal” as it has finite energy.



This is not an “energy signal” as it has infinite energy.

- So there is no use trying to characterize this signal by its energy!

*Many theoretical signals
do not have a finite
energy...*

*Many theoretical signals
do not have a finite
energy...*

In that case it is more
useful to measure their
energy per unit time
(called “Power”)

Signal Power is the
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Mathematically speaking...

$$P_x = \lim_{T \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{T} \int_{-T/2}^{T/2} |x(t)|^2 dt$$

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(provided, the limit exists)

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$x(t)$ is a power
signal if

$$0 < P_x < \infty$$

Q. How would the power formula look for a periodic signal with period T_0 ?

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- Since power is “energy per unit time”, we could find the energy in a single period of a periodic signal and divide it by the period...

$$P_x = \frac{1}{T_0} \int_{-T_0/2}^{T_0/2} |x(t)|^2 dt$$

Q. Suppose that $x(t)$ is an energy signal (i.e., it has finite energy). What is the power of $x(t)$?

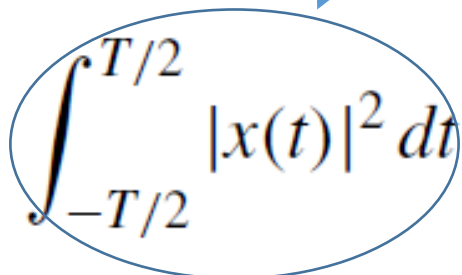
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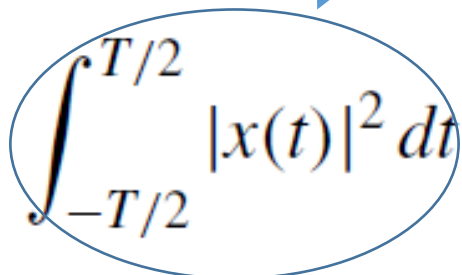
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(since this E_x , and we are given that $E_x < \infty$)

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Infinit
e

A blue oval encircles the integral term $\int_{-T/2}^{T/2} |x(t)|^2 dt$ in the equation. A blue arrow points from the word "Finite" to this oval. Another blue arrow points from the word "Infinit e" (split across two lines) to the $T \rightarrow \infty$ part of the limit expression.

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Finite

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Infinit
e

$P_x = 0$

Lesson: an energy signal cannot be a power signal!

- Another measure we sometimes use is the *rms value*.
- rms (root-mean-squared) value of a signal is the square root of its power...

$$x_{rms} = \sqrt{P_x}$$

There are, in fact, many more ways of “measuring” a signal. Try to find some.

HW Activity: Bring to Next Class

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- There are signals that are neither energy signals nor power signals. Find a few examples.

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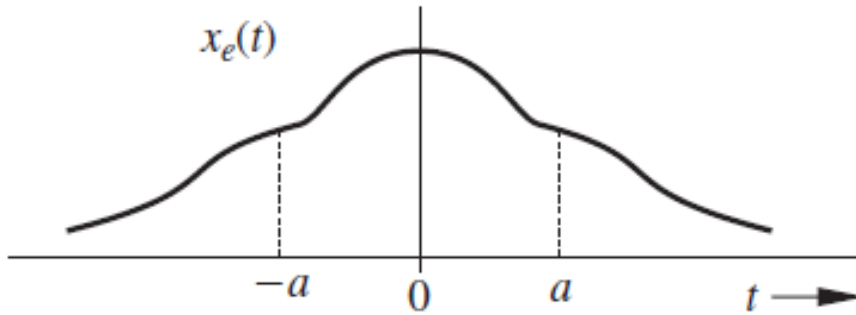
- There are signals that are neither energy signals nor power signals. Find a few examples.
- Show that an energy signal can never be a power signal.
- Show that a power signal can never be an energy signal.
- Show that all practical signals are energy signals (since real-life signals are always time-limited and have no infinite values).

HW Activity: Bring to Next Class

- There are signals that are neither energy signals nor power signals. Find a few examples.
- Show that an energy signal can never be a power signal.
- Show that a power signal can never be an energy signal.
- Show that all practical signals are energy signals (since real-life signals are always time-limited and have no infinite values).
- Show that time-unlimited periodic signals (with no infinite values) are power signals.

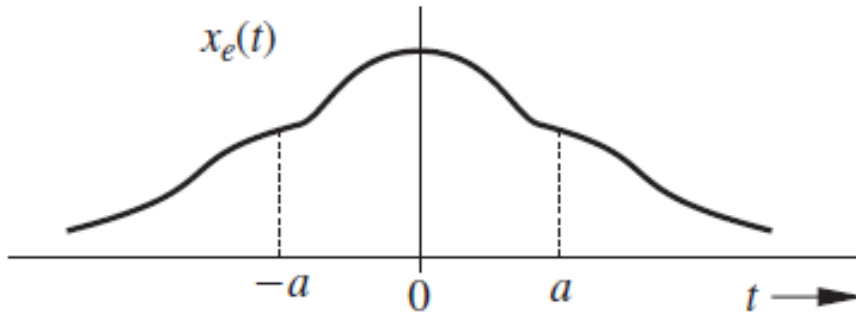
6. Does the signal have any symmetries we could exploit?

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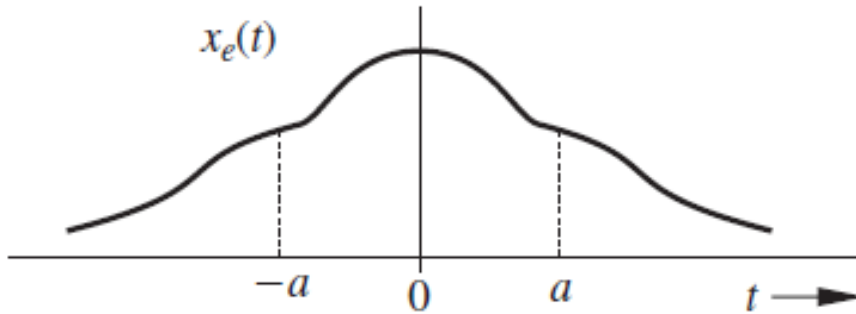
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- Does this signal have any symmetry?
 - Yes, it is symmetric about the y -axis

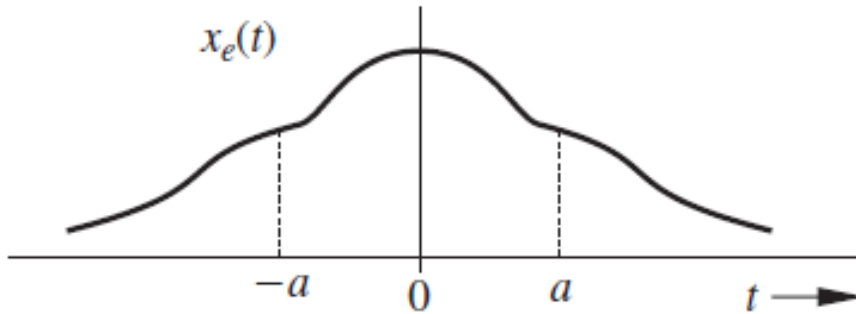
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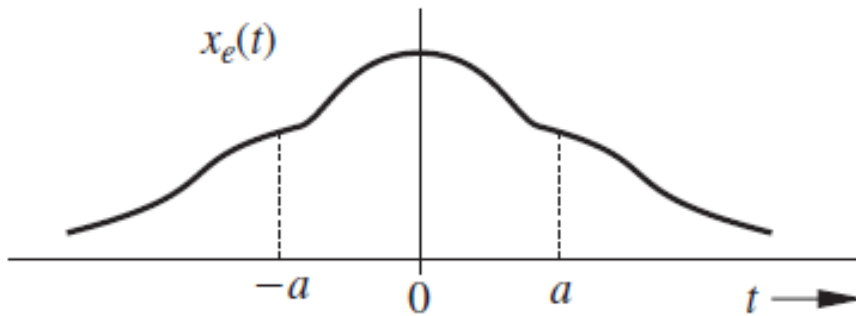


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Can you write this property mathematically?

$$x_e(t) = x_e(-t)$$

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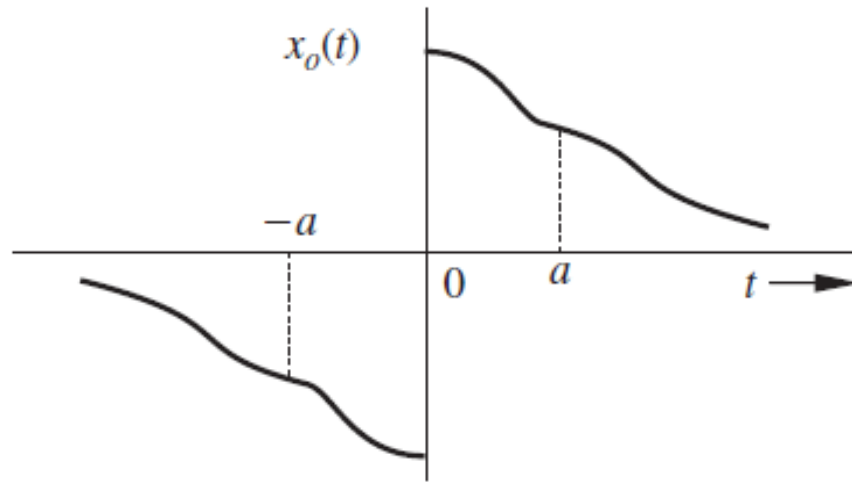
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Even Signal

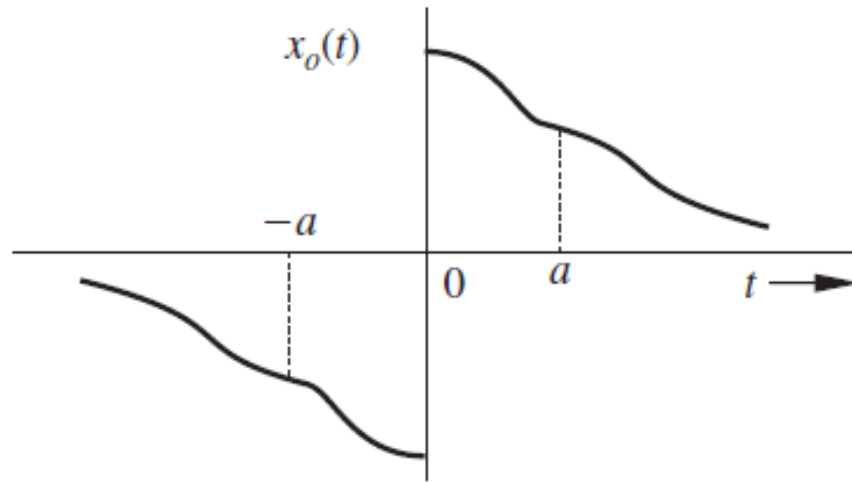
A signal which is symmetric about the vertical axis is called an even signal.

6. Does the signal have any symmetries we could exploit?



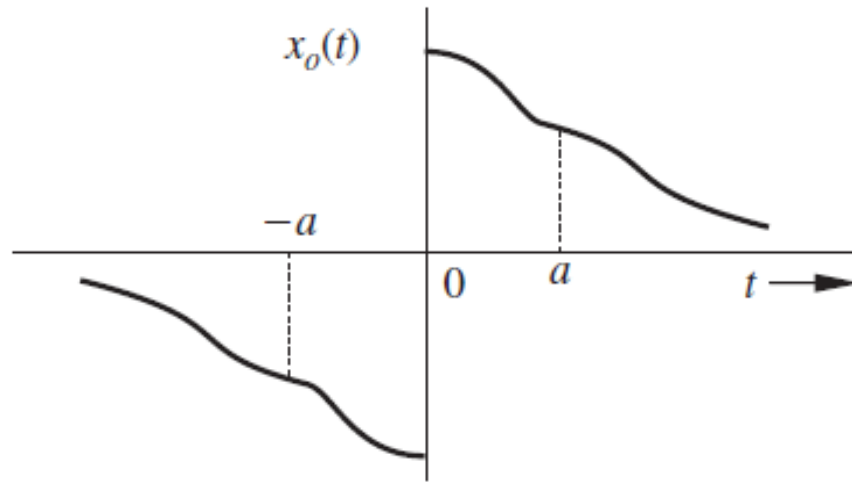
- Does this signal have any symmetry?

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- Does this signal have any symmetry?
- It is anti-symmetric about the y -axis

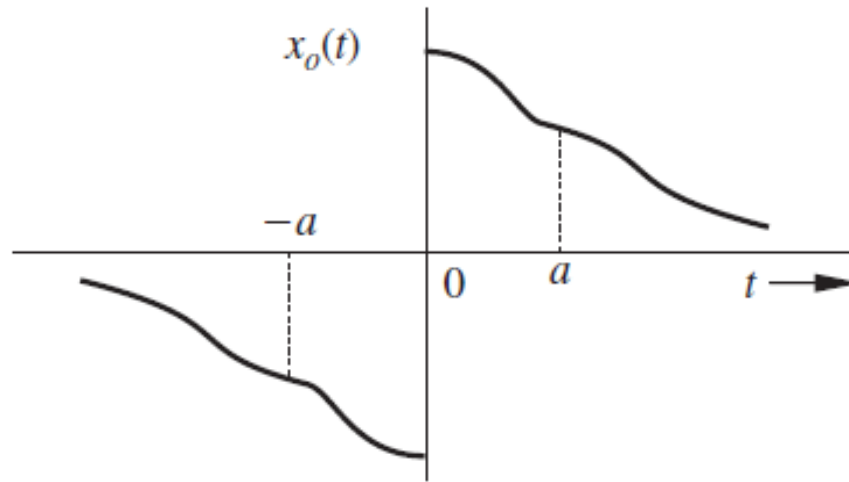
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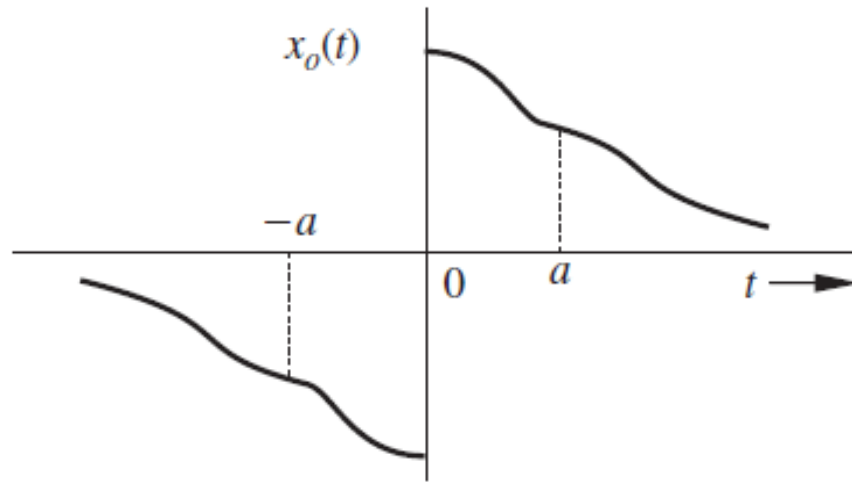


- Does this signal have any symmetry?
- It is anti-symmetric about the y-axis

Can you write this property mathematically?

$$x_o(t) = -x_o(-t)$$

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Can you write this property mathematically?

$$x_o(t) = -x_o(-t)$$

ODD Signal

A signal which is anti-symmetric about the vertical axis is called an odd signal.

Even vs.
Odd

Why are we
interested?

Even vs.
Odd

Why are we
interested?

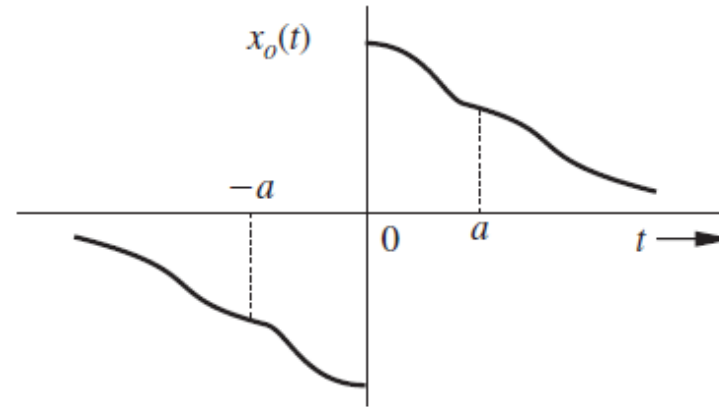
Such properties often help
in analysis and
computation!

Even vs. Odd

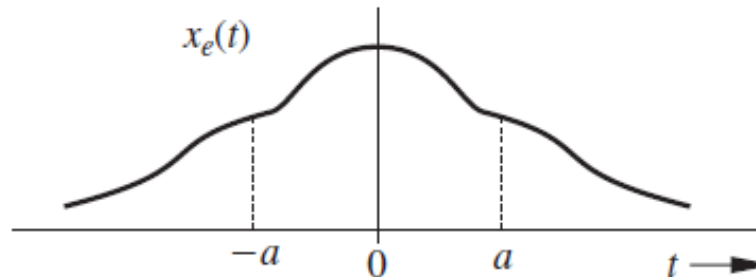
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Such properties often help in analysis and computation!

Can you simplify these integrals?



$$\int_{-a}^a x_o(t) dt$$



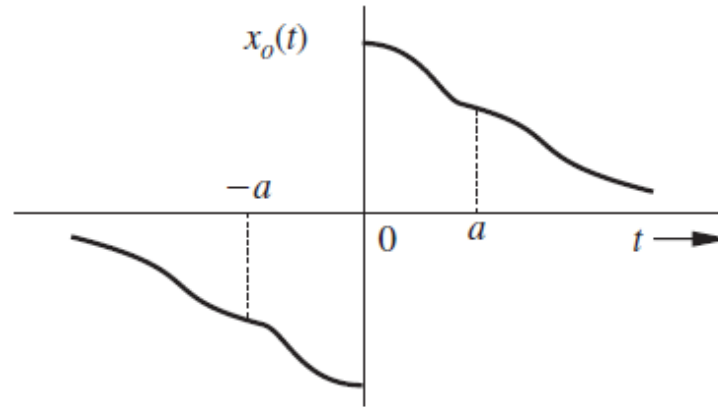
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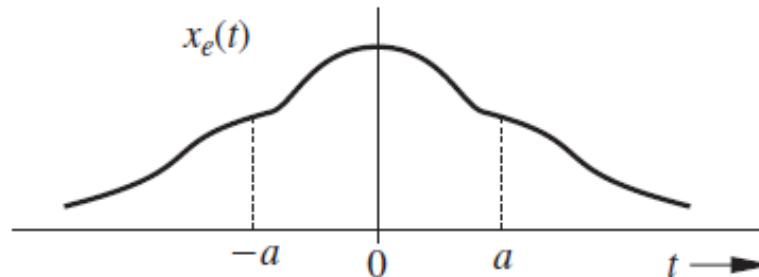
Why are we interested?

Such properties often help in analysis and computation!

Can you simplify these integrals?



$$\int_{-a}^a x_o(t) dt = 0$$



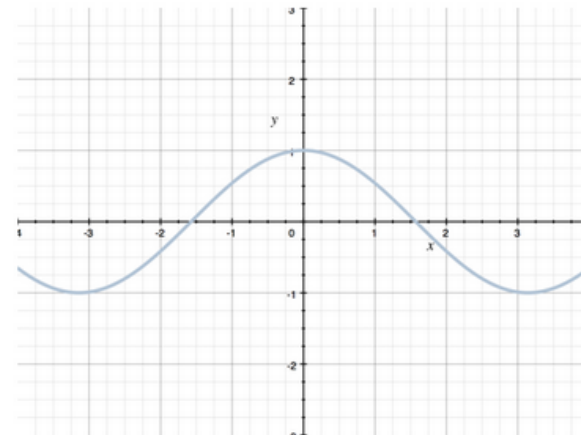
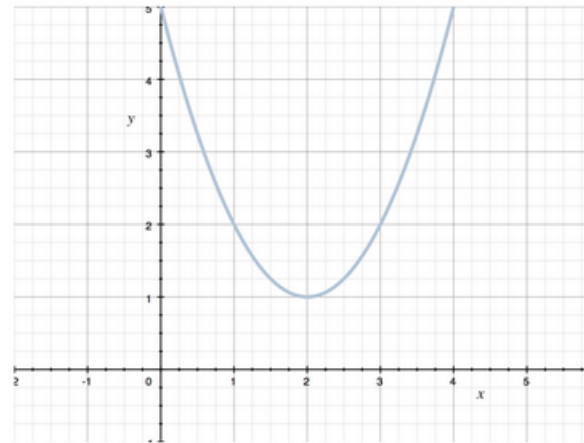
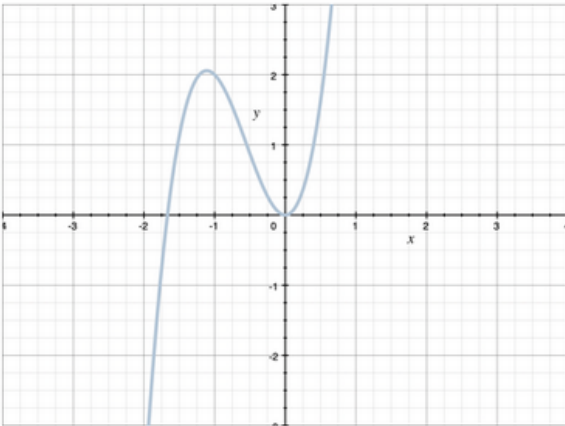
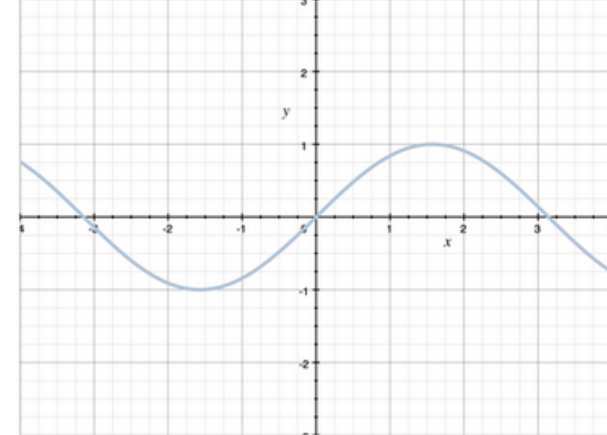
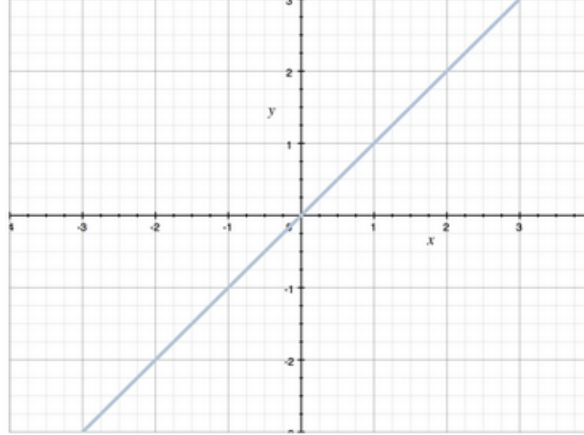
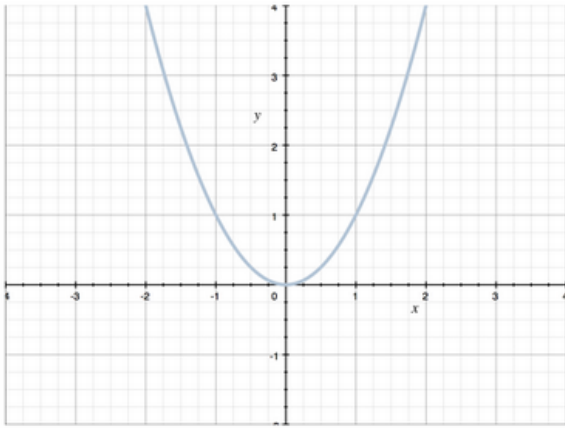
$$\int_{-a}^a x_e(t) dt = 2 \int_0^a x_e(t) dt$$

Even vs. Odd

Can you think of and draw some functions that are even, odd, or neither?

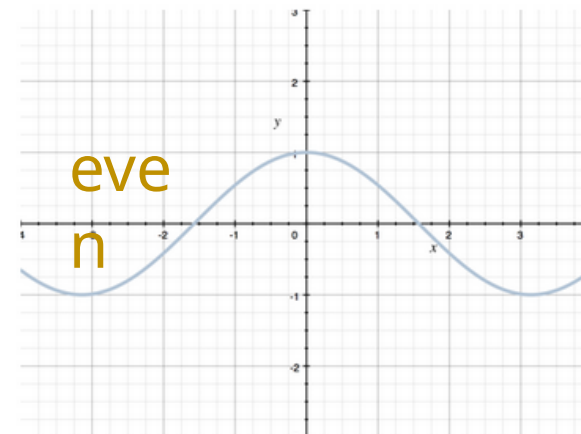
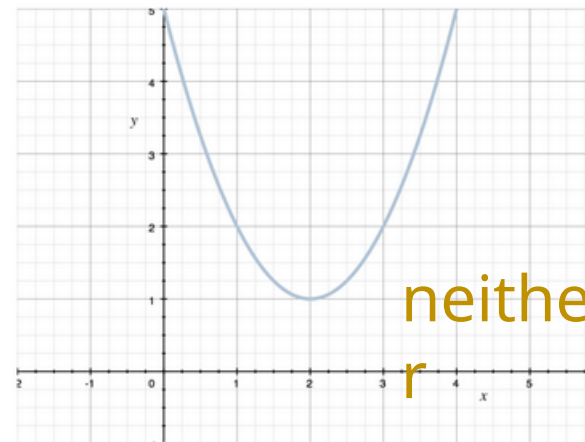
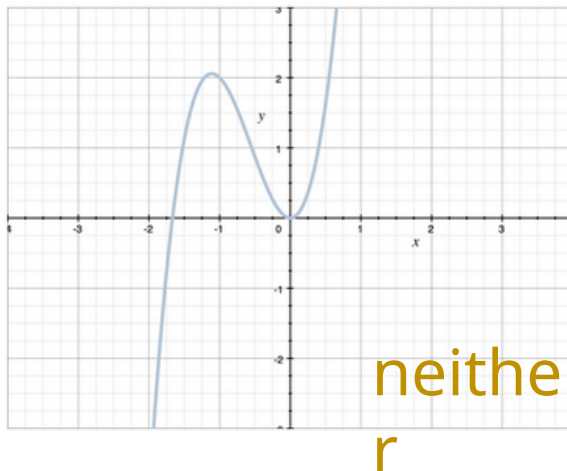
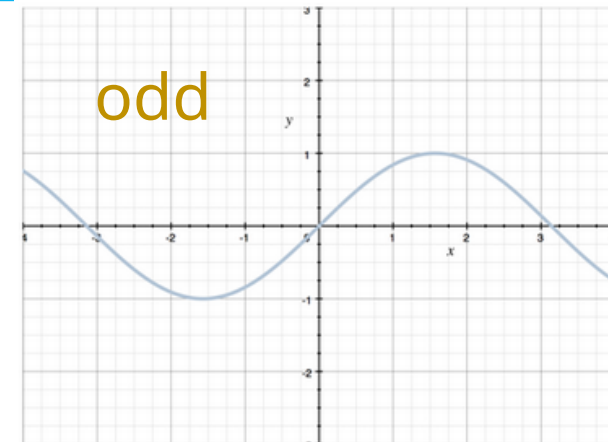
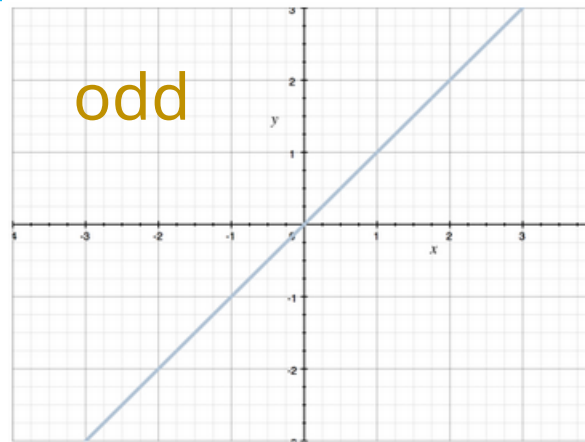
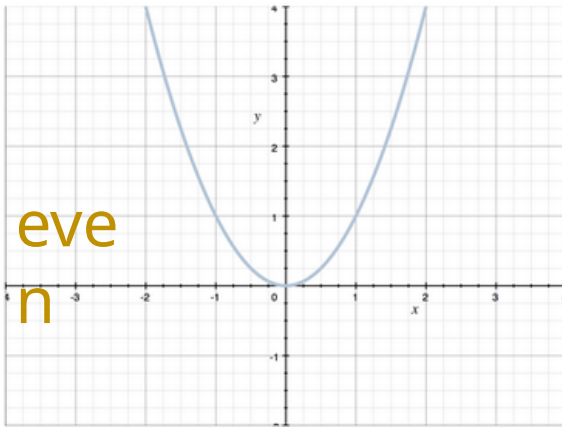
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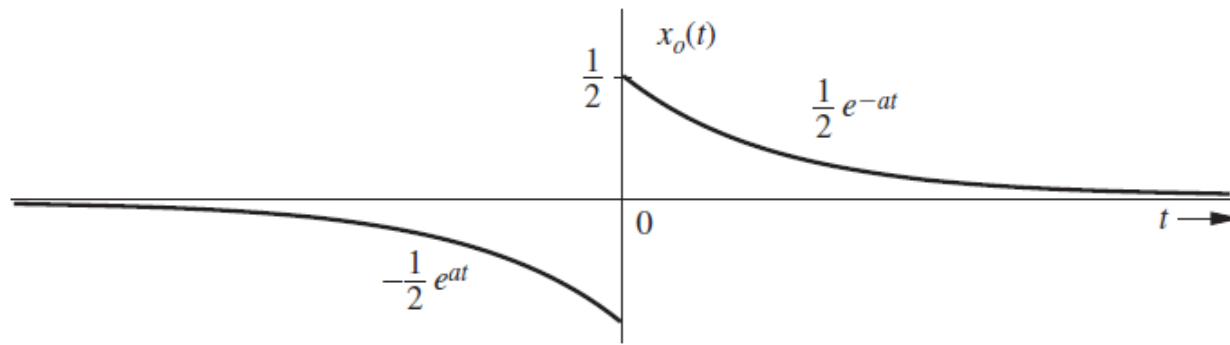
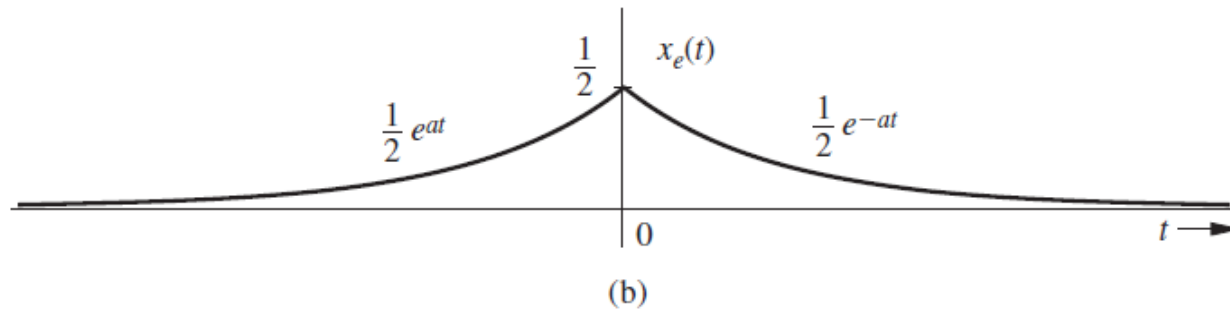
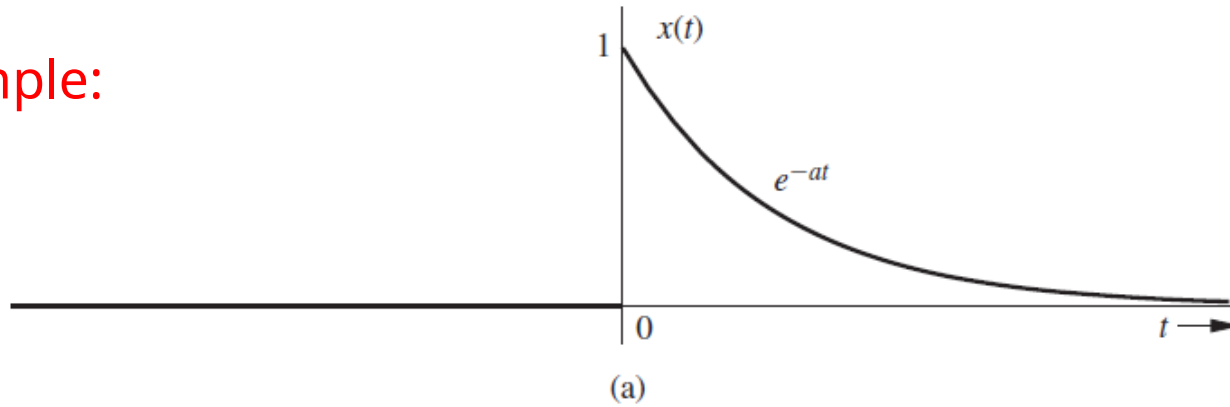
$$x(t) = \underbrace{\frac{1}{2}[x(t) + x(-t)]}_{\text{even}} + \underbrace{\frac{1}{2}[x(t) - x(-t)]}_{\text{odd}}$$

We can write a given function as a sum of even and odd functions

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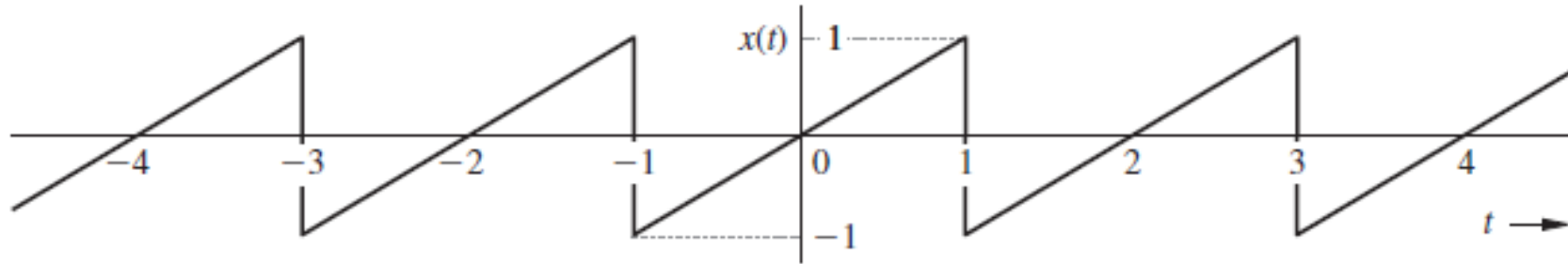
HW: prove that the even and odd parts shown are actually even and odd.

Example:



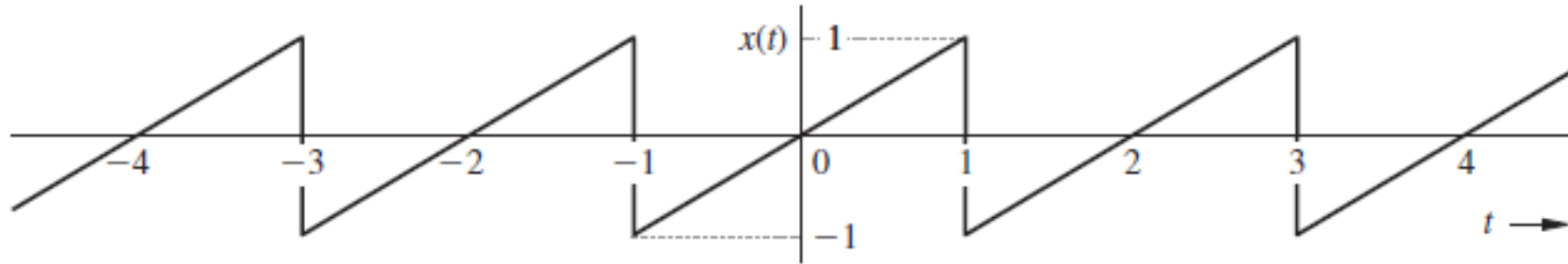
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*Let us analyze some
more signals...*



Consider the signal shown above (with $t \rightarrow \infty$):

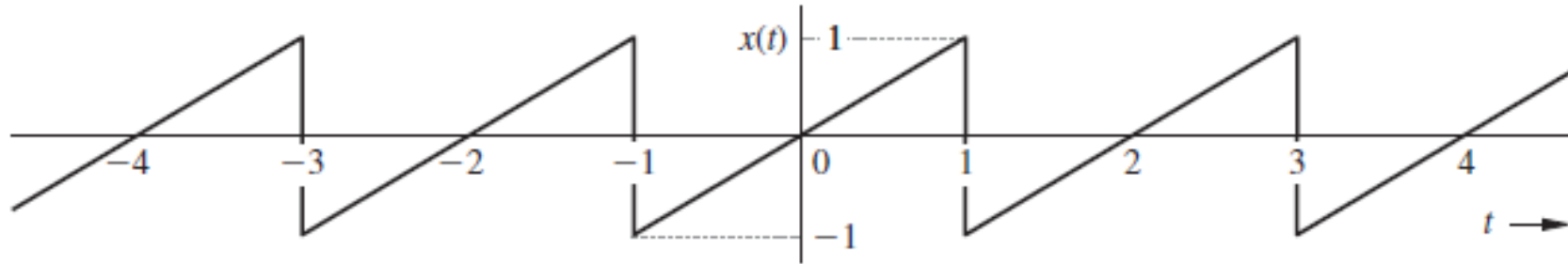
- Is it periodic? If so, find the period.
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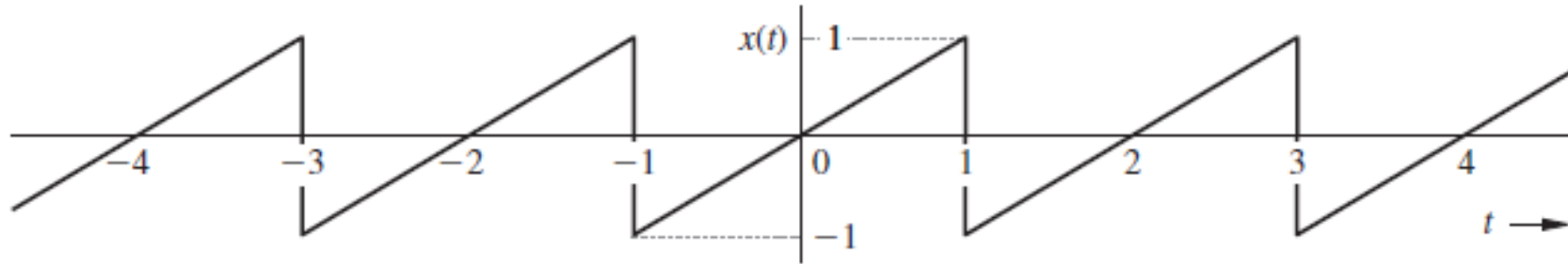
- Yes, the signal is periodic with period $T_0 = 2$



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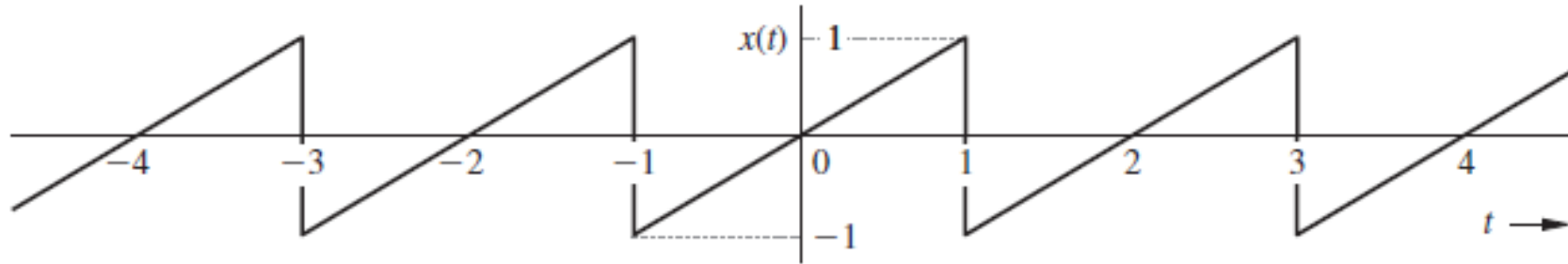
- Yes, the signal is periodic with period $T_0 = 2$
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 - Why? Clearly, the absolute square of the signal will have infinite area under it.



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- It is a power signal as its power $P_x = \frac{1}{3}$ is neither zero nor infinite.

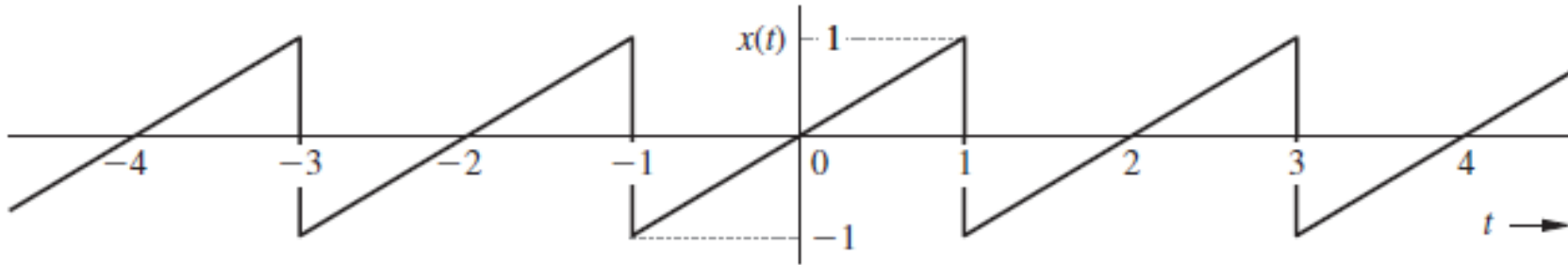


Consider the signal shown above (with $t \rightarrow \infty$):

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$$P_x = \frac{1}{2} \int_{-1}^1 |x(t)|^2 dt = \frac{1}{2} \int_{-1}^1 t^2 dt = \frac{1}{3}$$

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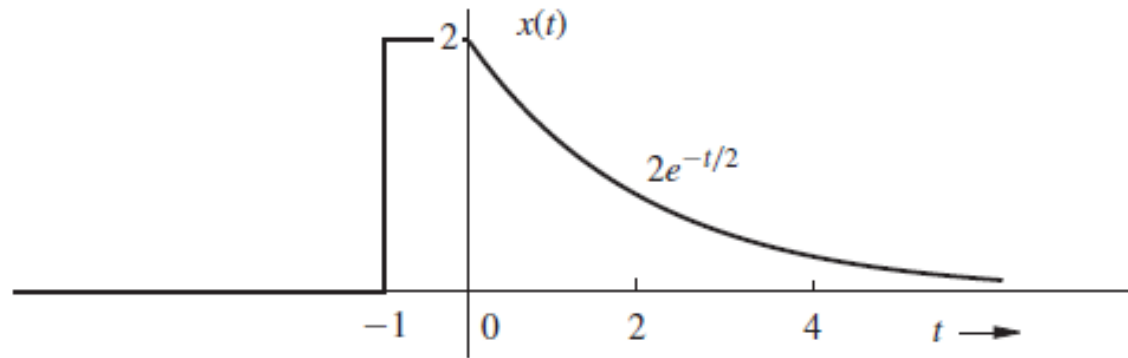
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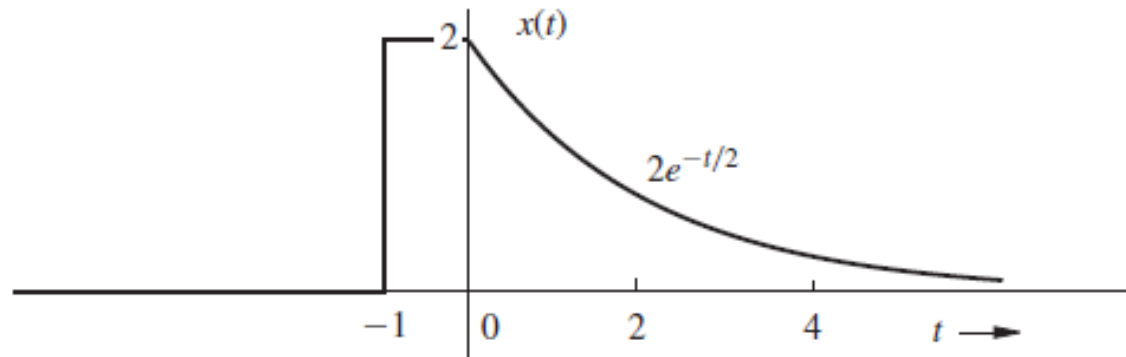
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Here, we have used the formula for the power of a periodic signal and that fact that given signal's period from -1 to 1 can be modeled as $x(t) = t$



Consider the signal shown above (with $t \rightarrow \infty$):

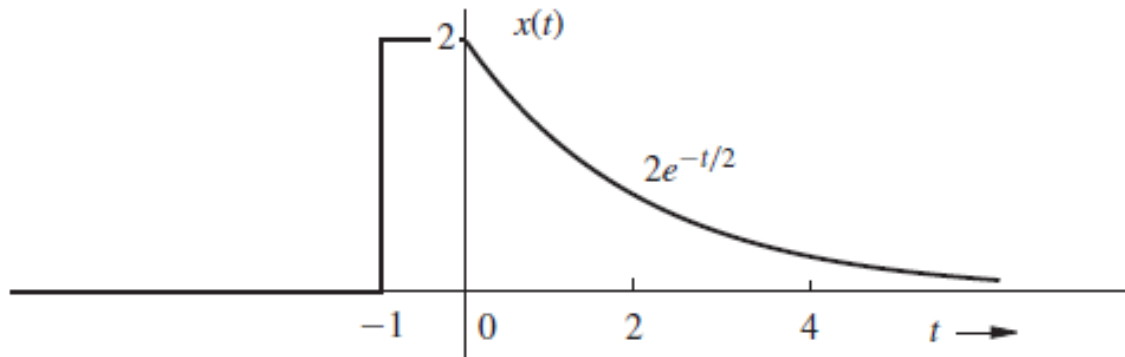
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First, can you write this signal mathematically?

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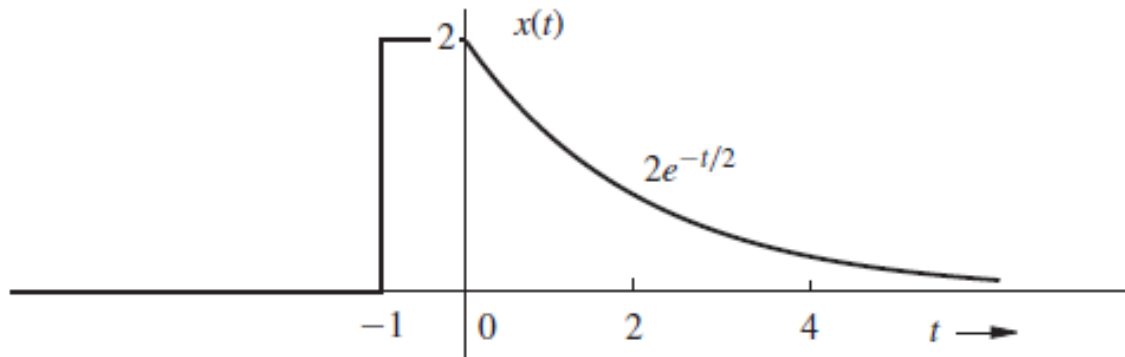


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$$x(t) = \begin{cases} 2, & -1 \leq t \leq 0 \\ 2e^{-t/2}, & t \geq 0 \end{cases}$$



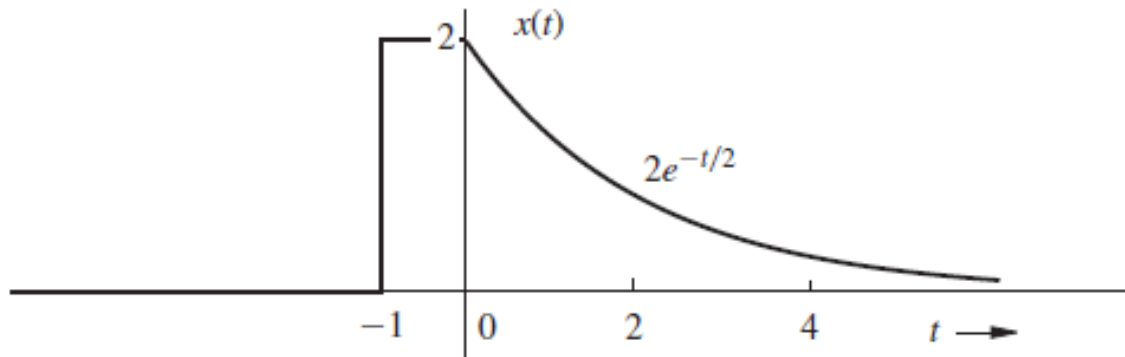
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- It is not periodic.



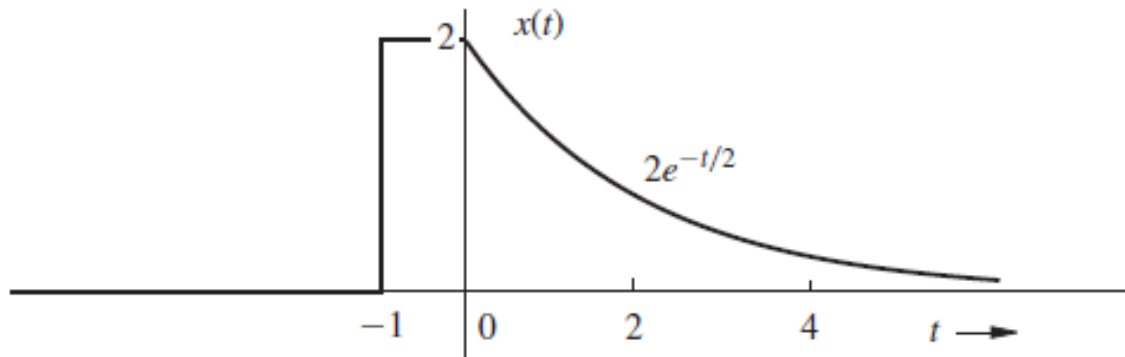
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- It is not periodic.
- It is an energy signal since its energy $E_x = 8$ is finite.



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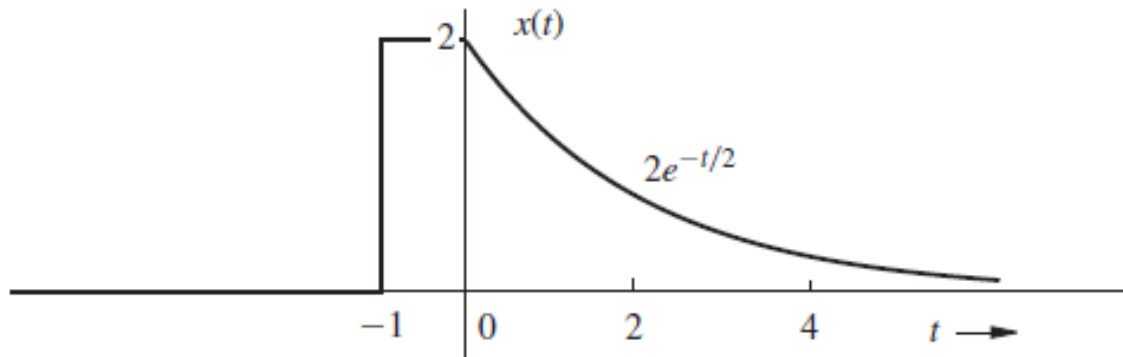
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$$E_x = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |x(t)|^2 dt = \int_{-1}^0 (2)^2 dt + \int_0^{\infty} 4e^{-t} dt = 4 + 4 = 8$$



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- It is not periodic.
- It is an energy signal since its energy $E_x = 8$ is finite.
- It is not a power signal, since an energy signal will always have zero power.

Questions?? Thoughts??

